



FUTURE-READY TECHNOLOGY

MERKURY CONSUMER 360

JANUARY 2024



OFFERING SUMMARY

Merkury Consumer 360

WHAT IT IS

To be AI-ready and drive true personalization and modern experience and analytics, brands must have the right data environment. Future-ready data teams operate well governed, highly connected data environments to support marketing, CX, insight and analytics teams as well as emerging AI needs.

This offering sets the stage for multi-year engagements that grow in line with client data maturity.

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

- Connects your data, identity and technology to remove silos
- Drives more value from your customer data
- Creates a modern data stack with a composable architecture
- Enables efficient integration and investment with CDP platforms
- Adds scale and adaptability to your CX operations
- Enables unified customer experiences

WEDGE

Can be delivered at less than \$100k USD, to 'open the door'.

Clean Room

\$50-150k USD

Launch TBD

AI Data Readiness Audit

\$100-175k USD

See Technology Strategy offering

ENGAGEMENTS

Are over \$100k USD that you can sell individually or together.

Data Strategy

\$100-200k USD

Launch TBD

Martech Roadmap

\$200-240k USD

See Technology Strategy offering

Merkury Consumer 360

\$500k-\$1.5M+ USD

What's in this document?

Everything you need to get started with our Merkury Consumer 360 offering .

1. **The story:** Presentation-ready materials that you can use in client and prospect meetings. Slides include speakers notes.
2. **Offering definition:** The details of what you can sell – packages with guide pricing, defined activities, deliverables and timelines.
3. **Sales support:** Materials to help you understand and sell the offering.
4. **About our GTM:** background information on Merkle's 2024 GTM and business architecture.

Where can I find more?

The Merkle Business Architecture and Go-to-Market SharePoint includes a video walk through of the Future-Ready Technology presentation, as well as a written talk track.

The SharePoint also has all materials related to our go-to-market, including toolkits, corporate case templates, and other presentation materials. The SharePoint is regularly updated.

You may also reach out directly to: Pete Rogers
peter.rogers@merkle.com

When was this file last updated?

January x, 2024

This document will regularly be updated through 2024 with improved and new materials.

To make sure you have the latest version, check the Business Architecture and Go-to-Market SharePoint.

WHAT'S INSIDE

Merkury Consumer 360 Sales Story

Engagement Definitions

Market Commercial Enablement

About Merkle's 2024 GTM

Merkury Consumer 360

These slides are ready for client presentation. The next section of this deck includes links to a talk track and other enablement materials

Companies are striving to deliver personalized experiences to consumers across all channels.

“

Data issues plague personalization efforts.

Data is a top challenge discussed in personalization programs. Companies grapple with data deprecation on top of missing data, siloed data, non-actionable data, and whether that data is static or dynamic.”

- Forrester Best Practice Report, 2022





Data is siloed. Customers are not.

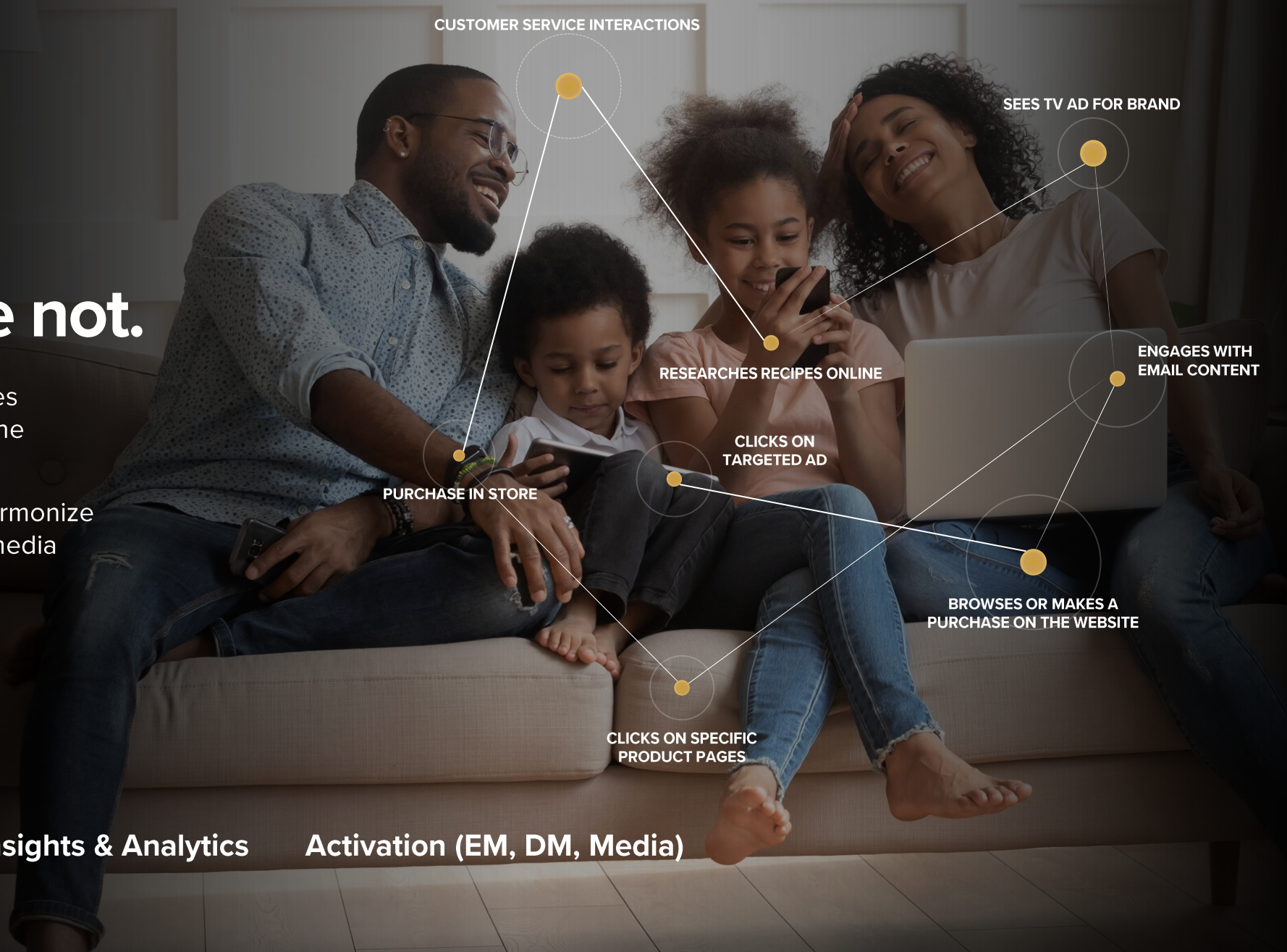
Today, marketers and their agencies are working in siloes that fracture the customer experience.

dentsu is uniquely positioned to harmonize ways of working, integrating paid media and CRM strategy and executions.

Database Enhancement

Insights & Analytics

Activation (EM, DM, Media)



The Challenge

We hear many challenges from organizations trying to better manage the current consumer data landscape:

Disparate and siloed data sets with no clear ownership

Continuous shifts and challenges in the identity landscape

Expanding consumer privacy regulation

Creation of a truly complete view of the consumer across customers and prospects

Confusion around the data warehouse, sales/service/marketing suites, and CDPs

Detail and history to satisfy the deep analytics use cases that fuel the adoption of AI/ML and the true automation of cross channel next best action and personalization.

Our Answer

Eliminate the confusion and silos and better enable your business and marketing:

Flexible, scalable, privacy safe data assets

Architecture, tools and processes focus on democratizing the data asset and data literacy for analytics, insights and measurement

Architecture focused on connecting data, analytics and insights to drive the customer experience through content, commerce and loyalty

Solving for consumer data benefits the entire enterprise

CEO

“How can I build and leverage our most valuable asset, our customer data, to deliver maximum value to the organization?”

CMO

“How do I deliver more personalized experiences consistently across online and offline channels?”

CIO

“How do I process more data at faster speeds leveraging cloud technologies?”

VP, CUSTOMER SERVICE

“How do I leverage the customer data asset both enhance the call experience and reduce call times?”

VP, COMMERCE

“How do I leverage what I know about our customers to create more shoppable moments?”

VP, BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE

“How do I make our customer data asset available to individuals across our enterprise to act on?”

PRACTITIONER, DATA SCIENCE

“How do I leverage our customer data to predict the next best interaction with our customers?”

PRACTITIONER, MARKETING

“How do I leverage our customer data to drive more personalized and relevant experiences?”

PRACTITIONER, INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

“What is the most optimal way to house a single source of truth for customer data?”

What if...

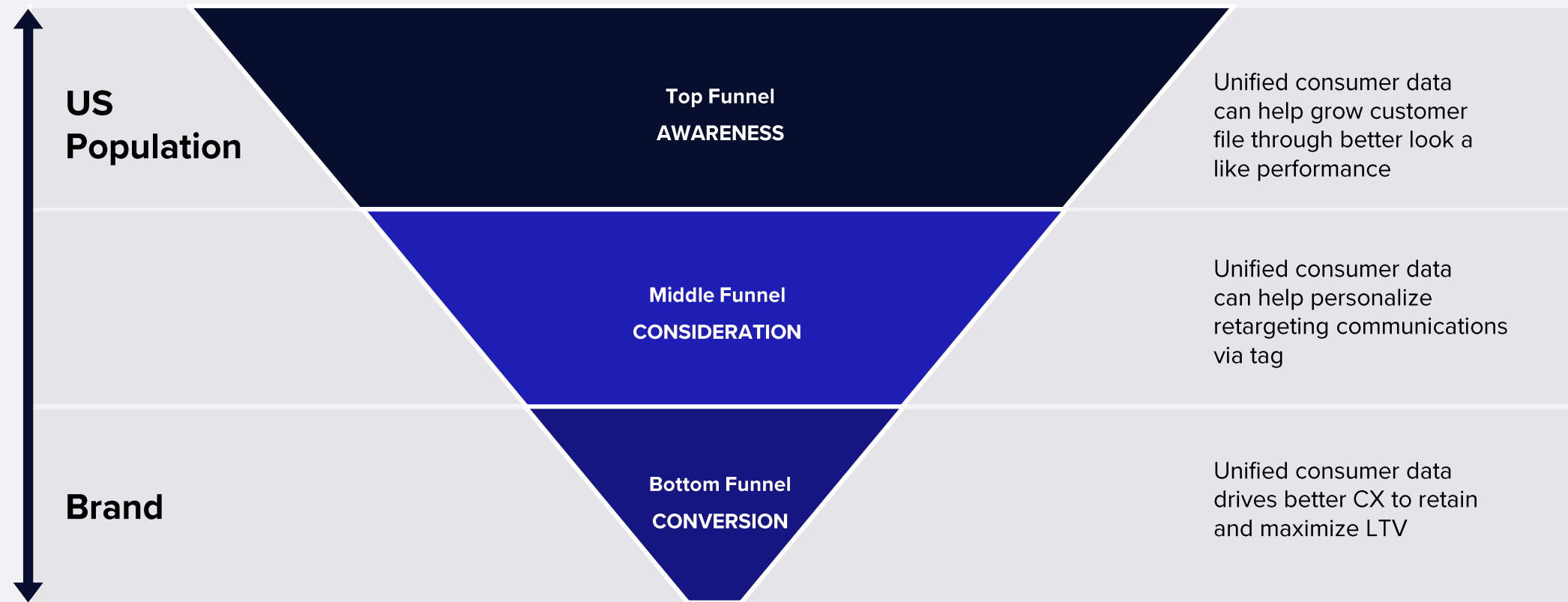
You could better connect your personalization efforts?

You could leverage your 1P data throughout the funnel?

You could easily expand your universe from customer to consumer?

You had a unified consumer data solution?

Expand from customer to consumer



Transform the customer experience with a unified data platform

In the rapidly evolving landscape of digital marketing and customer experience, organizations are maximizing the potential of their complete data ecosystem to scale existing capabilities and innovating new ones, such as advanced analytics and AI. The **Merkury Consumer 360 solution powered by Merkury Identity** is Merkle's industry-leading framework for managing, analyzing, and activating data that powers your customer experience transformation.

360° Customer View

Integrating data and identity from all touchpoints to create comprehensive customer profiles and segmentations for customer experiences.

Real-Time Personalization

The ability to leverage any data type to easily accommodate the complex breadth of your use cases for personalized marketing.

Predictive Customer Insights

Utilizing advanced analytics and AI/ML to anticipate customer needs and behaviors, and actionable insights for rapid optimization of strategies.

Omni-Channel Management

Ensuring democratization of marketing data to provide consistent customer experiences across all channels and touchpoints.

A customizable, composable solution

- **Cloud-agnostic, Snowflake based** – unites existing customer data from disparate sources with built in apps and frameworks for data governance and security on AWS, GCP, or Azure
- **Merkury Identity at the center** to bring your data together and **Merkury Data to enrich** your customer profile and enable connections to the digital ecosystem
- Allows for **complete ownership of your first-party data asset** with the ability to flex endpoints and integration needs when the business is ready
- Founded on **composability**, provides **interoperability with any CDP** of choice
- The result is a more powerful, more connected, more **holistic customer profile**





Merkury **Consumer 360** *powered by Merkury*

**Connects your data,
identity and technology**

**Drives more value from
your customer data**

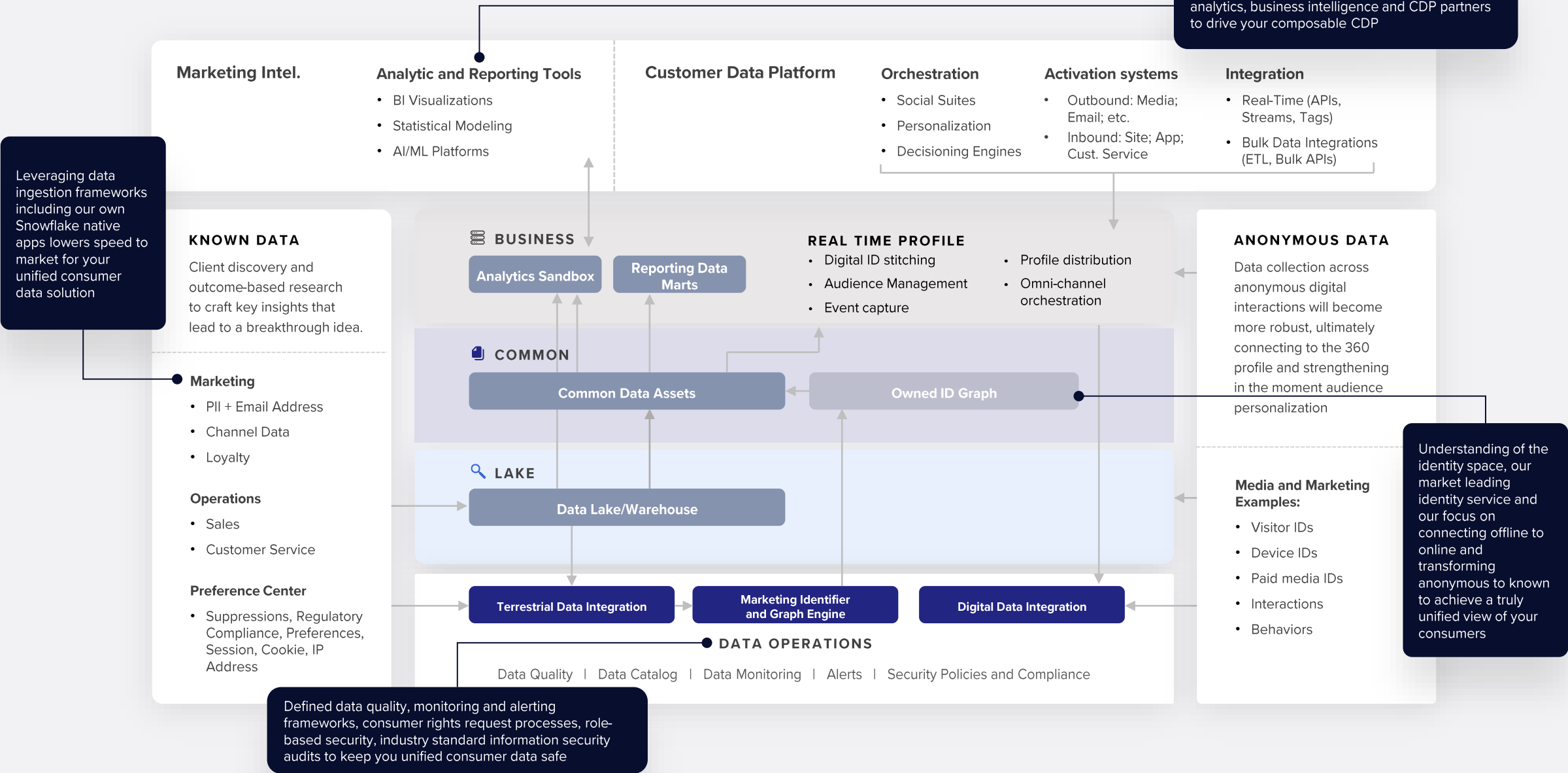
**Creates a modern tech stack
with a composable
architecture**

**Integrates efficiently with
best-in-class CDP
platforms**

**Adds scale and
adaptability to your CX
ops and organization**

**Delivers unified
consumer experiences**

What a good unified consumer data solution looks like



Merkury Consumer 360

powered by Merkury

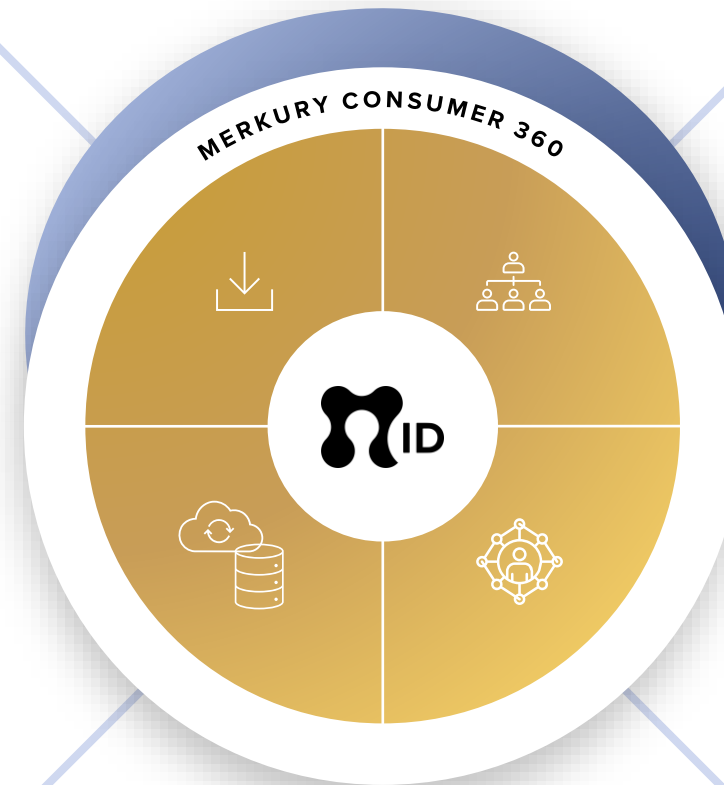
A unified data platform made of Merkle products, services, and best practices along with 3rd Party vendor capabilities to drive your composable CDP strategy and deliver enhanced customer experience outcomes.

DATA PIPELINES

Prepare, enhance, and integrate consumer data in any of the industry-leading cloud platforms leveraging a variety of cloud-native integration tools including our own proprietary Snowflake native apps.

CLOUD DATA WAREHOUSE

The foundation for your consumer data, allowing you to take advantage of data sharing and zero copy, to secure your data and consumers' privacy.



ORCHESTRATION & ACTIVATION

Seamlessly integrates into any decisioning, activation and CDP platforms for cross-channel personalization.

ANALYTICS, INSIGHTS & AI

Empowers your analytic capabilities. Includes the deployment and integration of customer profiling and identity scoring that enable intelligent decisioning and activation based on customer value.

Merkury Consumer 360 delivers on any platform

The Merkury Consumer 360 solution adds a robust layer of **composable accelerators, frameworks, services, and best practices** – a critical value-add designed to improve speed to market on CX outcomes and value realization.

Snowflake Native Apps

- Merkle – Data Loader
- Merkle – Data Profiler
- Merkle – Identity Connector
- Merkle – Audience Publisher

Data Handling

- Data Governance
- Data Ingestion
- Data Quality
- Data Engineering
- Data Enhancement

Identity

- Digital / Online Identity
- Terrestrial Identity
- Single unified ID

Frameworks

- File Handling / SOA
- Data Integration Services
- Derived Attributes
- Custom Rules



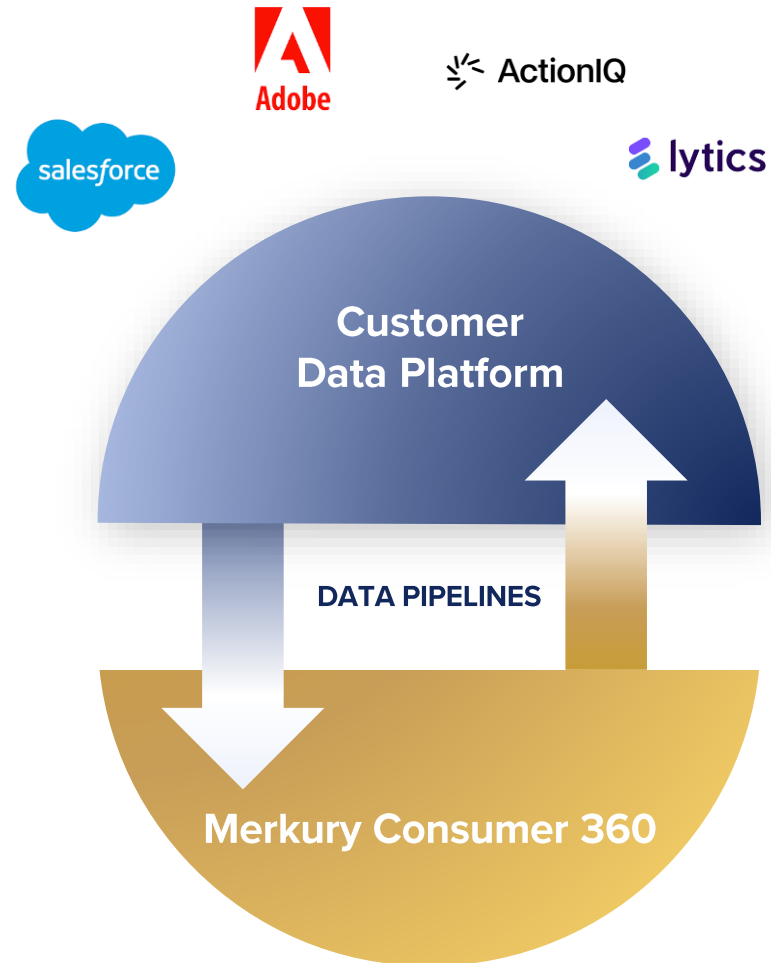
Merkury Consumer 360

powered by Merkury

A unified data platform made of Merkle products, services, and best practices along with 3rd party vendor capabilities to deliver enhanced customer experience outcomes by **integrating seamlessly via a variety of methods including data sharing and zero copy**, allowing organizations to best leverage the components of their composable CDP.

+ CDP

CDPs have vast capabilities and enable marketers to reach consumers in real time – but ultimately the value of any CDP is only as good as the quality and actionability of the data it ingests, and the first-party data assets available.



Real-time Data Capture

Real-time Customer Profile

Customer 360

ID Stitching

Data Hygiene

Model Development

Custom ID Graph

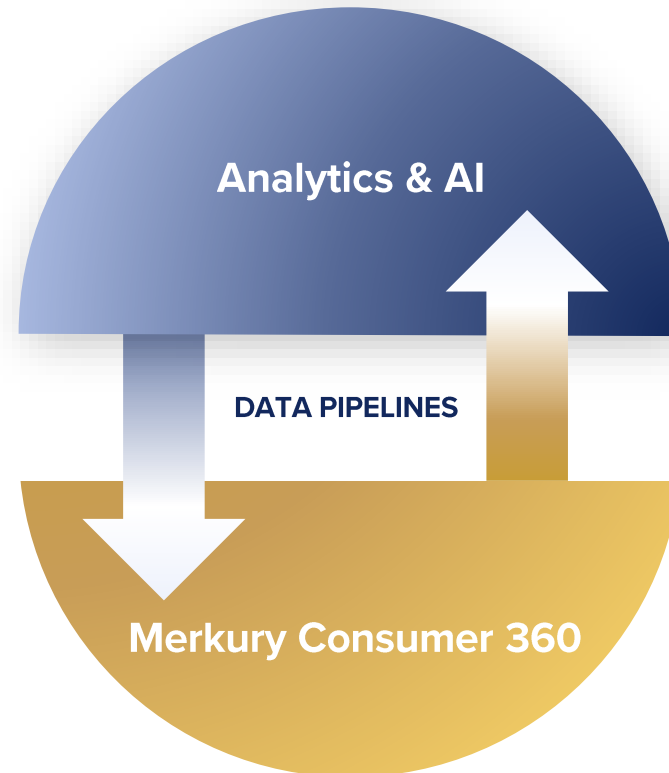
Analytics and Insights

Merkury Consumer 360 unlocks insights and intelligence

A unified data platform made of Merkle products, services, and best practices along with 3rd party vendor capabilities to deliver enhanced customer experience outcomes by creating a **robust foundation of data to unleash AI capabilities.**

+ AI

AI has the ability to supercharge marketing efforts – but ultimately the output of any AI model is only as good as the quality and availability of the data it has to leverage.



Expanding Universe of AI tools:

GenCX

Snowflake Cortex

AI Agents/Adaptive Experiences

Organized data structures

Connected data

Cloud native integrations

Merkury Consumer 360 Evolution

CORE

The CORE of the Merkury Consumer 360 solution provides clients with everything they need to get started with their composable CDP strategy

WHAT'S INCLUDED

Rapid Cloud Environment Creation

Automated:

- Data Ingestion
- Data Profiling
- Identity Processing
- Data Security

Data sharing, zero copy integrations

Ready-to-connect to your CDP of choice

Direct query capability

EXTENSIONS

Extensions are additional tools, services and/or integrations that enhance existing data or enable additional value driving use cases

Custom Integrations

Retained Analytic team to build Custom insights

Vertical Specific Consumption Structures

Reverse ETL Tool Integration

Analytic Tool Integrations

Merkury Media Audience Activation

Custom Channel Partner Integrations

Clean Room

Merkury Data Enhancement

SUPPLEMENTAL EXTERNAL NARRATIVE SLIDES

We do this at scale.

“

Merkle serves as the glue
that connects departments,
data and agencies.



MANAGING TECHNOLOGY

160 Marketing
databases
deployed

2500+ Managed
Servers

50 Mobile apps

250pb Data traffic
through network
annually

7pb Online storage for
client hosted solutions

PROVIDING EXPERTISE

2100+
Technology
employees

2600+
Data and Analytics
employees

2
Offshore global
delivery centers

ENABLING DATA

160b CDI records
processed
annually

150k Campaigns
annually

10k Analytic models
annually

8/10k BI reports
annually

350k Files
received
monthly

20m Mobile messages
delivered

Merkle is proudly a Snowflake Premier Partner

DIFFERENTIATION

**Merkle is the Snowflake Partner
connecting IT to the Marketing “C” suite**



EXPERTISE

4,700+

Data and Analytics Experts

30+

Migrations completed

**Modern Marketing
Data Stack Identity &
Activation Partner**

2 years in a row

LEADERSHIP

Merkle operates across
Services, Merkury Powered by
Snowflake, and Marketplace



Snowflake Native Apps

Merkle enables the Customer 360 through a suite of Snowflake native apps. Our suite of Snowflake native apps currently address four key functions necessary to implement and enable your Customer 360.

Building a Unified Consumer Data Solution

Merkle's deep heritage in data management combined with Snowflake architecture enables our clients' 360 view of their customer. By reducing time to market and up front investment costs, our suite of Snowflake native apps help us drive business outcomes for our clients.

SNOWFLAKE APP	WHAT IT IS	WHY IT WORKS	KEY OUTCOMES
Data Loader	The data loader actively monitors configured cloud storage locations to automatically ingest structured files into tables	With a simple initial configuration, automates the data ingestion process to load new files into the configured Snowflake data warehouse with no additional user interaction required.	• Reduces cost of building data pipelines • Reduces time to value to build and continually enhance the customer 360
Data Profiler	The data profiler provides a summarized view of all data in a given table with useful statistics for identifying data gaps, anomalies, and conducting general analysis.	Automates data analysis across tables in a Snowflake data warehouse, allowing users to gain insights into their data and improve data quality.	• Rapid understanding of data across the customer 360 • Uncover data quality opportunities to improve the customer 360
Identity Connector	The identity connector analyzes incoming data on ingestion, maps input field names to enable Merkury, Merkle's industry leading identity platform, to connect disparate data by a single ID.	When coupled with Data Loader, makes the process of applying identity a simple configuration activity with no manual ETL required. Quickly take data from disparate sources with differing keys to determine unique individuals to form customer profiles.	• Enables the connectivity of brands' online and offline first party data • Enables connectivity to industry leading third party data enhancement • Enables connectivity to digital platform activation through ID application.
Audience Publisher	The audience publisher enables digital audience activation from your Customer 360 via the Merkury Connections platform.	Makes the process of publishing audiences to Merkury simple for Snowflake customers.	• Reduces integration costs for digital audience publishing • Connects customer 360 to digital ecosystems

Merkle is proudly a GCP Premier Partner


SELL | SERVICE | BUILD
Premier Partner
Google Cloud

DIFFERENTIATION

**Merkle is the GCP
Partner connecting IT to
the Marketing “C” suite**

EXPERTISE

500+
GCP Certified experts globally

17 Years
As a GCP Preferred Partner

20 Years
Google Strategy Experience

SPECIALIZATION

- Marketing Analytics Specialization
- Data and Analytics Specialization
- #1 Google Analytics Sales and Solution Partner in the world
- Authorized Looker Reseller
- \$7.1 Billion in Global Media Spend with Google

NEW AND NOTEWORTHY:

- 1st GCP Services Partner to list capabilities on the GCP Marketplace
- Actively developing new GenAI solutions in partnership with GCP
- Hand-picked to Participate in the ADxAI Funding Program


SPECIALIZATION
Marketing Analytics
Google Cloud


SPECIALIZATION
Data Analytics
Google Cloud


Over 500
GCP Certified
Experts


Authorized
Looker Reseller


#1 GA Reseller
in the World

Merkle is proudly a AWS advanced services partner



DIFFERENTIATION

**Merkle is the AWS
Partner connecting IT to
the Marketing “C” suite**

LEADERSHIP

Merkle operates across Services,
Merkury Powered by Snowflake,
and Marketplace

100+

Foundational, Associate, Professional,
Specialty AWS certifications

SPECIALIZATION

- Advertising Martech Competency
- Data and Analytics Services Competency
- Amazon Redshift Service Delivery Partner
- Amazon Marketing Cloud Partner



CASE STUDIES

Long term partnership and modernization: Shift, save and scale

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

After hosting and managing the member and prospect data platform for years, Merkle drove migration to a more modern architecture to combat the following challenges:

- High total cost of ownership and executive technical debt
- On-premise solution had limited compute and storage capacity
- Due to processing limitations, were not able to execute identity processes to enable a faster prospecting cadence
- Couldn't process semi-structured and unstructured datasets
- Limited data democratization and integration capabilities
- Needed a flexible, nimble, scalable, and highly-performant platform

MERKLE SOLUTION

- Seamlessly migrate the platform and capabilities to Amazon Web Services
- Establish future-state technology roadmap to deliver single identity management and integration of member, prospect, and big data solutions for integrated marketing
- Enable capability growth from single channel to multi-channel
- Holistic view of the customer journey from a prospect to a member
- Enable enhanced prospecting and targeting analytics

\$3M+

of infrastructure cost savings
over five years

\$30M+

known individuals in member
solution

\$65M+

known eligible individuals in prospect
solution that ingests over 500 million
records from multiple list sources



Helping our financial services client navigate migrating to cloud

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

- Expand prospect universe to acquire new customers.
- Provide seamless omni-channel experience to prospects and customers.
- Reduce time to market on current campaigns; ability to ingest, process and analyze more data in near real-time fashion.
- Reduce spend on maintenance; free up resources to focus more on strategic initiatives.
- Analyze audience selection criteria and activate addressable audience in an agile and real-time fashion.

MERKLE SOLUTION

- Merkle outlined a cloud native architecture leveraging AWS and Snowflake to alleviate the capacity constraints of legacy on-prem prospect database.
- Developed private identity graph by resolving prospect and customer identities from multiple channels in both terrestrial and digital realms.
- Implemented clean room and data sharing capabilities on pseudo-anonymized data so that Client can perform analysis without manual intervention from Merkle resources.
- Productized, hardened and automated data processing, audience selection and campaign launch activities on Snowflake thereby freeing up analytic resources to focus on strategic initiatives.

RESULTS

- Savings of 5 business days in improving the time to market for direct mail campaigns.
- Reduction of 2700 man hours/year in freeing up resources to focus on strategic initiatives.
- Increase the universe by 350,000 new prospects through identity resolution.
- Increased speed and efficiency to resolve identities using Merkury and onboard 3rd party data to the database
- Real-time audience scoring and suppression logic processing possible for Client's analytics team.
- Paves the way for credit bureau data to be shared via Snowflake data share in near future thereby further shrinking time to market for launching new campaigns.



Data management modernization in retail

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

A long-term managed services client embarked on a holistic organizational data modernization strategy driven by the IT org. BUT:

- The client's existing customer data hub was hosted in Merkle's data center and not easily connected to other tools and data stores
- Growing customer base and engagement sources had led to scale challenges with keeping up with the volume of data
- Growing client analytics team desired ownership of production modeling source code repository

MERKLE SOLUTION

Integrate with client's data modernization strategy collaborating with both IT and Marketing to unlock value from their customer data asset:

- Migration to a modern, cloud-based data lake environment on Azure/Snowflake
- Data lake integrated with their CDP (Tealium)
- Data science toolset for personalization capabilities (Databricks)

63%

Reduction in processing cycle time to enable quicker user data access and insights creation

10%

Reduction in operational support effort due to the adoption of cloud platforms



Driving personalization to deliver more guests for a global parks and resort brand

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Fuel growth and boost lifetime customer value by improving personalization across their many CX touchpoints, while having data siloed in unscalable systems across the enterprise.

MERKLE SOLUTION

- Merkle migrated their customer data to the cloud
- Layered in a robust identity resolution solution
- Installed activation capabilities powered by Analytics

60%

Faster time to market for new analytical models

42%

Of site visitors linked to known profiles

75%

Reduction in IT support effort

27%

Of guest records consolidated by Identity resolution



Driving media audience creation and activation in QSR

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Quickly creating an environment to facilitate audience segmentation with pipelines to media activation. Data was siloed and not analytics ready to be able to easily segment customers for differentiated experiences.

MERKLE SOLUTION

- Input 40+MM customer records, 200+MM orders and 200+ defined customer segments into a Snowflake data warehouse
- Enhanced client supplied data with identity assignment and 3rd party data attributes
- Leveraged Merkle – Data Loader and Merkle – Audience Publisher
- Provided analytics environment for attribution and closed loop reporting

6x

Faster infrastructure set up

4x

Faster client data onboarding

80%

Reduction in time to enhance data with Identity keys



Enhancing media analytics and activation in CPG

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Reducing time to market and enhancing data for enhanced media activation. Data was siloed, with disconnected identities and not accessible for analytics and media use cases.

MERKLE SOLUTION

- Input 7+MM customer records, 2.0+BN transactions and 3.5+MM products into a Snowflake data warehouse
- Leveraged Snowflake share to add visibility to 30+MM web events
- Enhanced client supplied data with identity assignment and 3rd party data attributes
- Leveraged Merkle – Data Loader, Merkle – Identity Connector and Merkle – Audience Publisher
- Provided analytics environment for attribution, closed loop reporting and other analytics

75%

Faster time to market for analytics environment creation and accessibility

6x

Reduction in IT support effort required

75%

Fewer IT specialists needed



Engagement Definitions

This content outlines the various packages you can sell within this offering. The first is a wedge, or door opener, priced to help get the first sale. The rest are engagements that fit various needs related to the offering. Put one or a few in front of your client, based on their needs.

AI Readiness Audit

WEDGE



OFFERING DETAILS

AI Readiness Audit

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

With Generative AI's rapid advancement and adoption, organizations are struggling on how to get started. Merkle can help you find opportunities to extract value beginning with accessing and prioritizing data readiness.

OBJECTIVE

Audit and inventory the client's data infrastructure, quality and readiness for AI consumption.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

Martech Roadmap, Unified Data Solution

APPROACH & DELIVERABLES

- Inventory and understand current state of data ecosystem, capabilities, operating environment, and integrations
- Provide summarized documentation of the current data sources across the organization with gap analysis
- Define key recommendations to address the identified gaps and deliver on the needs of business and IT. Create organization data principles for all business units
- Craft a plan of sequenced initiatives over time with key milestones, roles and benefit to deliver a future-ready data strategy

**Investment:** \$100-175K**Timing:** 6-10 Weeks**Outcomes:**

- Evaluation on AI readiness

FROM INSIGHTS TO ACTIONS, FAST

**Moving from
insights to actions
quickly gives
marketing teams a
competitive edge.**



**Your organization's
data is *still*
your best asset and
biggest challenge.**

How to transform your data into AI-ready assets

According to Gartner, only 4% of CIOs and tech leaders currently have AI-ready data.

So, what is **AI-ready data** and how can you make your data **AI-ready**?



**Your proprietary data
is the true gold.**

- Your Algorithms
- Your Formulas
- Your Blueprints
- Your Schematics
- Your Know-how



**But it needs to
become AI-ready.**

- Secure
- Enriched
- Fair
- Accurate
- Governed



**Enriched AI-ready
data has metadata.**

- Enriched Data =
Data + Rules + Tags
- Enriched data is ready
for LLM consumption



**Rules are your rules
of doing business.**

- How pricing works in
your industry
- Laws of marketing
- Your brand values
- Market regulations
- Best practices

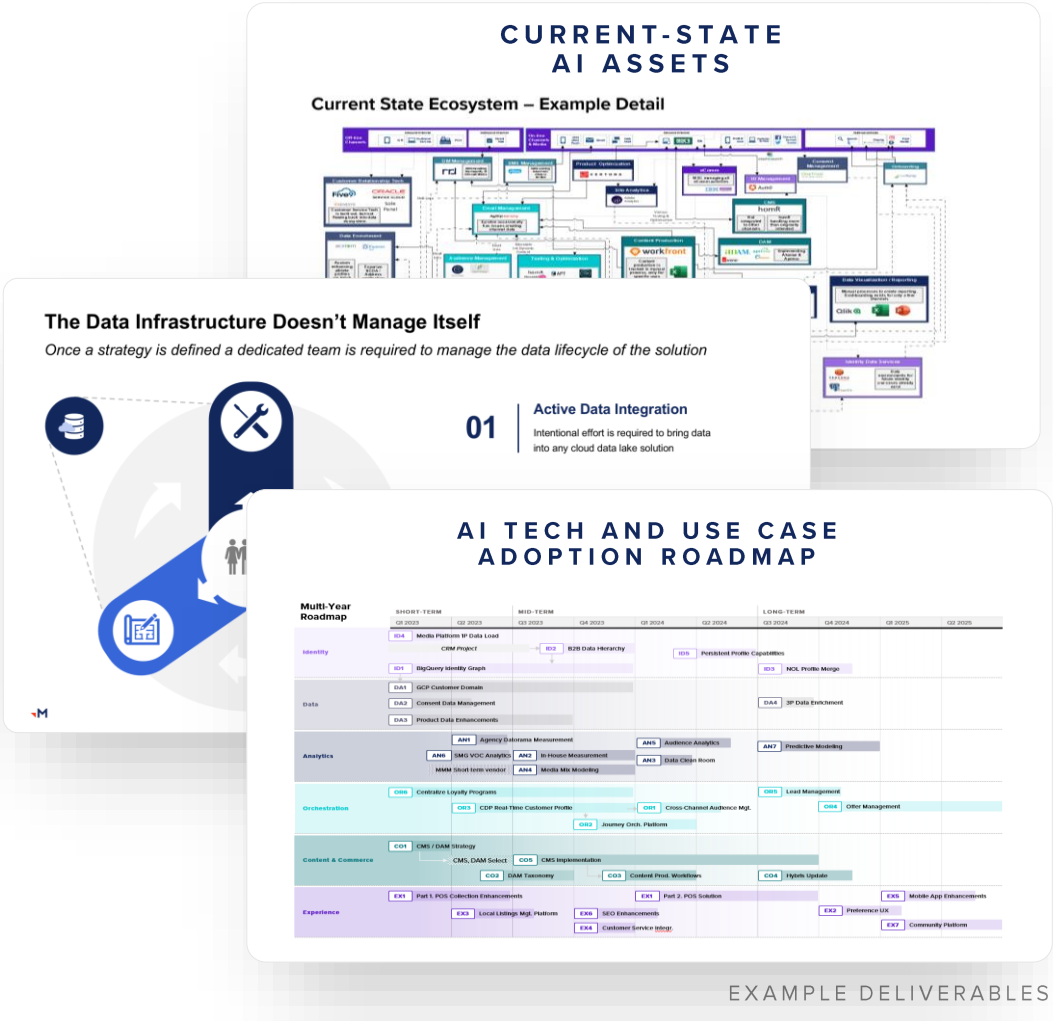
AI Readiness Audit

Audit and inventory your data infrastructure, quality, and readiness for AI consumption

With Generative AI’s rapid advancement and adoption, organizations are struggling on how to get started. Merkle can help you find opportunities to extract value beginning with accessing and prioritizing data readiness.

INCLUDES

- Inventory and understand current state of data ecosystem, capabilities, operating environment, and integrations
- Define key recommendations to address the identified gaps and deliver on the needs of business and IT. Create organization data principles for all business units
- Provide summarized documentation of the current data sources across the organization with gap analysis
- Craft a plan of sequenced initiatives over time with key milestones, roles and benefit to deliver a future-ready data strategy



EXAMPLE DELIVERABLES

Martech Roadmap

ENGAGEMENT



OFFERING DETAILS

Martech Roadmap

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

- Current technology stack is antiquated, siloed, or incomplete and the need for faster, simpler marketing requires technology modernization
- Challenges bridging the gap between marketing and IT
- Overwhelmed by the Martech landscape and need subject expertise
- Difficult deciding what investments to prioritize and what to do first

OBJECTIVE

Advise organizations to make smart technology decisions and craft a future state vision that connects customer experience and business goals to foundational technology

PULL THROUGH

Additional tech strategy work: strategic advisory, platform selection, integrated solution design. Any Merkle implementation or managed services work for technology initiatives identified

APPROACH & DELIVERABLES

- Audit of capabilities, architecture, operating environment, vision, and goals
- Gap analysis relative to vision and best practices
- Action and opportunities identification for value with relatively little effort in enablement
- Future state solution and recommended initiatives to close gaps
- Initiative prioritization based upon strategy, current projects, dependencies, and value
- Multi-period investment plan

OUTCOMES

Client receives a clear, sequenced, prioritized plan for technology modernization from current state to future state in relation to business vision and required use cases

CLIENTS EXAMPLES

NAPA, Zebra Technologies, Cisco, L.L.Bean, Jenius Bank, ACI, Cracker Barrel, Subway, Sony, OneMain Financial, AutoZone, Chevron

**Investment: \$200K- \$240K****Timing: 10-12 Weeks****Outcomes:**

- Full stack B2C or B2B CX Tech Blueprint
- Tech use case/ journey development
- Single capability tech strategies, such as Email, Content, Data, Identity, Etc.
- Quick wins to enable tech in a specific area

Merkle's Technology Consulting Practice

WHAT WE DO

- Drive holistic technology strategy by reviewing your Marketing Technology stack against industry proven best practices and maturity models
- Provide detailed, actionable recommendations and a roadmap that aligns necessary technology capabilities to achieve business goals
- Drive specific vendor and platform selection and RFP management
- Executive-level strategic alignment and goal setting
- Act as your trusted advisor through your experience technology transformation

WHY MERKLE

OBJECTIVE

Our process and focus is on your needs to drive your business success

ACTIONABLE

A plan to align business objectives with technology capabilities

EDUCATION

Ensure that enterprise stakeholders understand both enablement and value

We help clients:

Understand where they are today

Address technology gaps and pain points

Build a strategic technology roadmap

Make informed technology purchases

Address Key Challenge Areas

Comprehensive Technology Strategy

- Full Stack B2C or B2B Tech Roadmap
- Use Case Development
- Single capability tech strategies: Email, Content, Data, Identity, Commerce, Etc.
- Quick wins to enable tech in a specific area

8-12 Weeks

Long Term Vision and Roadmap

Platform/Vendor Decisions

- RFP Management
- CDP Selection
- Technology Platform Selection
- Technology POV or Vendor Overviews
- Miscellaneous Data or Platform related challenges

4-12 Weeks

Immediate Challenge

Integrated Solution Design

- Detailed current state ecosystem mapping
- Solution design principles and critical decisions required
- Future state blueprint and data flows
- Future state action plan

8-10 Weeks+

Strategic Solutioning

Retained Tech Strategy Advisor

- Roadmap Transition
- Subject Matter Expertise
- Supplementary support for strategic dentsu engagements
- Product Management
- Program Management
- Resource Staffing

6-12 Months

Vision to Action

ENABLED BY OUR CORE COMPETENCIES



visit martechmap.com to search, sort & filter

“

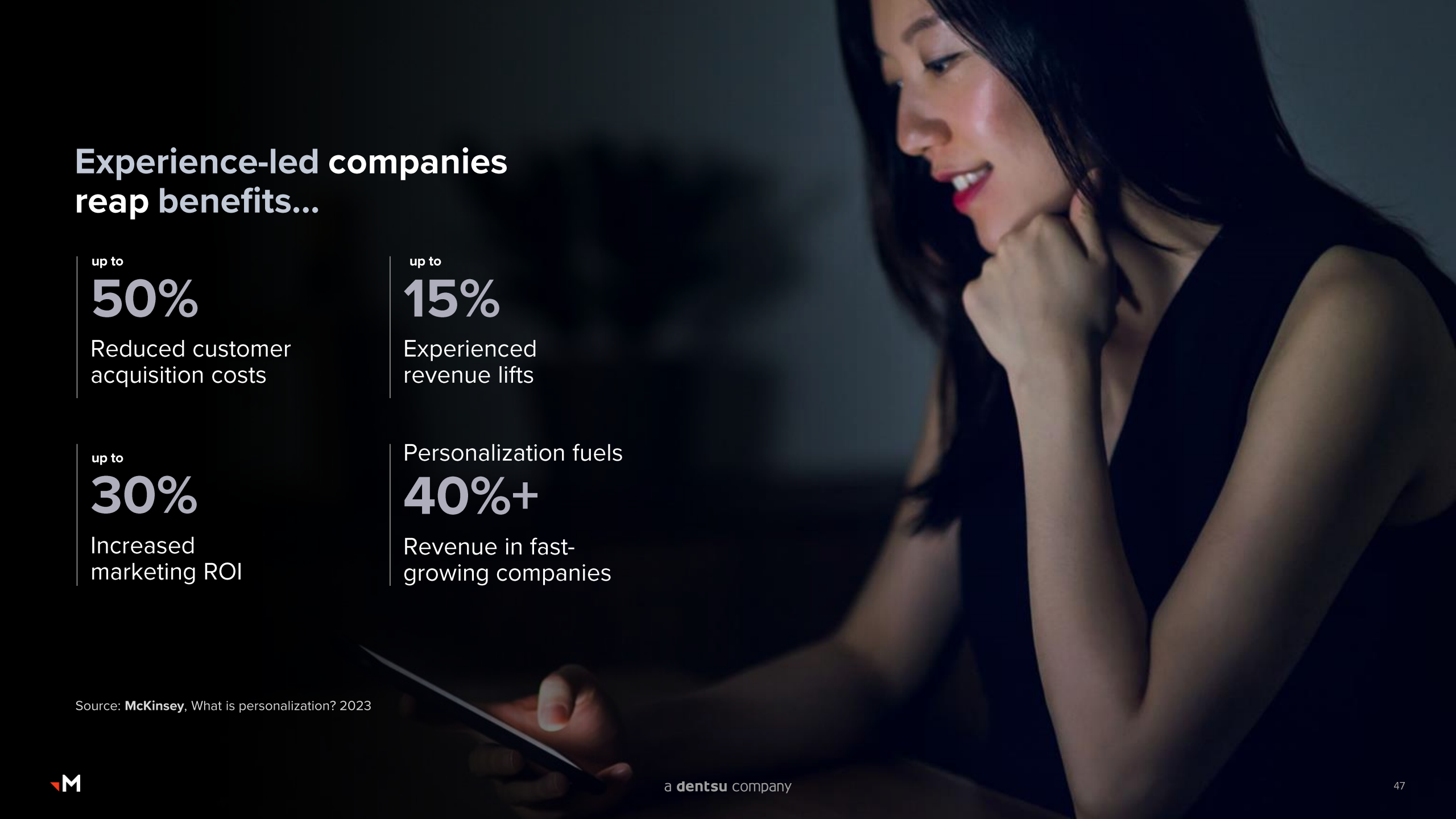
The marketing function has undergone **radical changes** over the last five years. As technologies continue to evolve and **customers continue to demand more personalized experiences**, it's a trend we can expect to continue in the next five years and beyond. Successful businesses are those that not only harness the power of these technologies to understand their customers but also **leverage technology to build connections and create greater value** throughout those relationships.”

- Tara DeZao, Director of Product Marketing, Pega

Most Important Trends to Watch

Besides **Generative AI...**

01	02	03	04	05
Write Once, Read Anywhere Single Source Data Profiles. Snowflake is almost there; the big three clouds will follow.	Blockchain, Quiet but Not Gone Web 3 is not dead. Blockchain potential for identity and loyalty is still evolving and should be explored	“Journey less” Technology Channel silos will become a past practice; As AI is incorporated into platforms the interaction with customers will happen where they are, in moment	Reverse ETL and The Composable Data Movement Native cloud integrations will continue to evolve; Both suite vendors and point solutions will become “Composable” to meet market need	Data Sharing Sharing of Data between brands will become the new currency enabled by the advancements in platforms and privacy.



Experience-led companies reap benefits...

up to

50%

Reduced customer
acquisition costs

up to

15%

Experienced
revenue lifts

up to

30%

Increased
marketing ROI

Personalization fuels

40%+

Revenue in fast-
growing companies

Source: **McKinsey**, What is personalization? 2023



CMOs who utilize **70%**
of their Martech stack's
capabilities

will achieve **20%**
better marketing ROI
than peers.

Source: Gartner – Marketing Technology Drivers of Genius Brand Performance 2020

51%
of Marketing leaders believe
investment in Martech

will increase
revenues by **10-20%**
over the next 5 years.

Source: Gartner – Marketing Technology Drivers of Genius Brand Performance 2020



a dentsu company

Why invest in Martech?



Engagement Velocity

Marketers need a Martech stack capable of processing large volumes of data and delivering rapid responses due to real-time, personalized customer demands.



Enhanced Personalization

To meet the expectations for increased personalization, the Martech stack should deliver tailored content, maximize data across multiple touchpoints, and execute advanced techniques to optimize consumer engagement.



Improved ROI

With better targeting and personalization capabilities, Martech can improve the ROI of marketing campaigns.



Data-Driven Decision

Advanced analytics from Martech tools offer valuable insights into customer behavior and campaign performance, aiding more informed decision-making.



Cohesive Customer Journeys

A fully integrated Martech stack can eliminate channel silos, highlight the customer journey, and connect interactions across channels through holistic customer profiles.



Improved Marketing Usability

Implementing an adaptable Martech stack, with flexible platform capabilities while incorporating new tech like public cloud, low-code, and headless solutions, will enable agile marketing.



Unify IT and Marketing Teams

Encourages IT-Marketing collaboration by establishing common goals, democratizing technology, increasing data transparency, improving efficiency, and fostering an understanding of each team's capabilities and objectives.

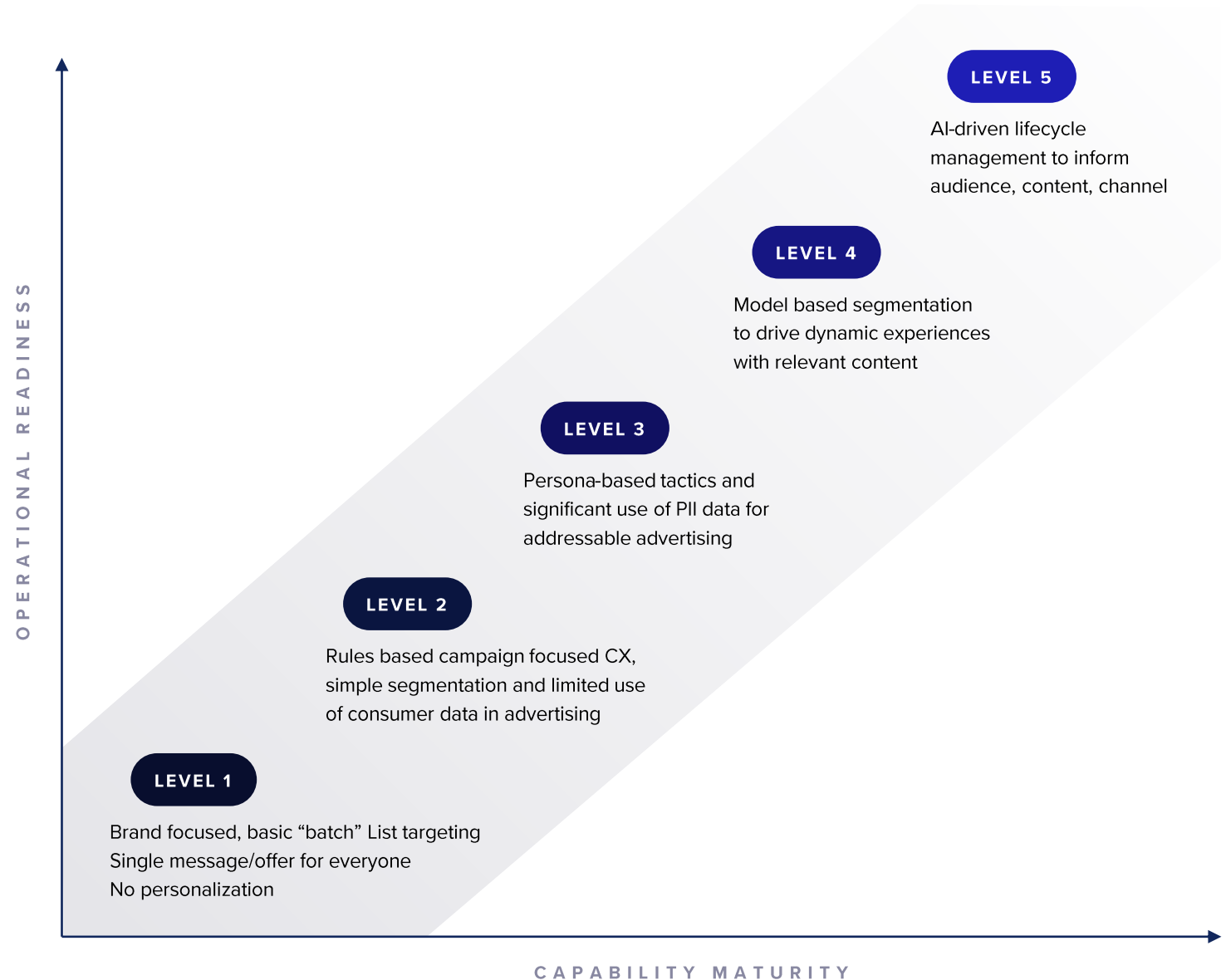
The Road to Customer-Centric Marketing Success:

Delivering an integrated cx is about technology and business



Merkle POV on Marketplaces Maturity

From nascent to industry leader



2024 CX Technology Capability Stack

EXPERIENCE	Creating and optimizing customer experiences	Virtual	Inbound		Outbound		Media		Physical					
CONTENT & COMMERCE	Creation and management of content, commerce and assets	Product Information Management	Commerce Management		Commerce Foundation		Dynamic Content Optimization / Orchestration		Content & Asset Management		Creative & Content Production			
ORCHESTRATION	Creation and governance of audiences and interactions	Real-Time Customer Profile	Testing and Optimization	Decision and Offer Management	Audience Management		Experience & Messaging Orchestration		Loyalty Management		Workflow Management		Service & Customer Management	
ANALYTICS & AI	Audience insights and marketing measurement	Data Visualization												
		Predictive Modelling & Segmentation		Measurement & Attribution		Experience Analytics		AI Foundation Models		Data Science & Engineering		Voice of Customer		
DATA & INFRASTRUCTURE	Consumer data stores and data democratization	Data In / Out		Data Value Optimization & Enrichment		Data Transformation		Vector DB NOSQL		Consumer Data Warehouse		Data Lake		
		Privacy, Compliance & Governance												
		Enterprise Data & Systems												
IDENTITY	Consolidated identification of consumers and their data collection preferences	Identity Resolution												
		PII Recognition				First-Party Identity Graph				Digital Recognition				

The Tech Stack as the Framework

A future state vision is developed to fill gaps by assessing client's current state ecosystem and business drivers against Merkle's best practice marketing technology stack.

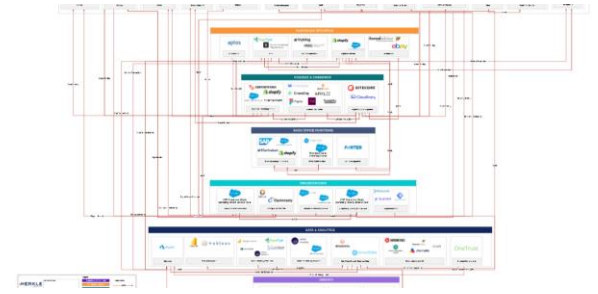
Customer Experience

Use Case: 2 – Recognizing the Customer Anywhere

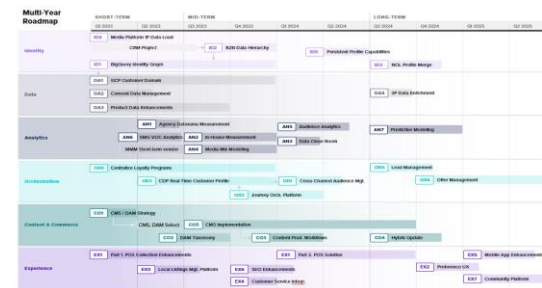
Summary: Identify the customer across multiple interactions and create an experience relevant to their individual behavior.



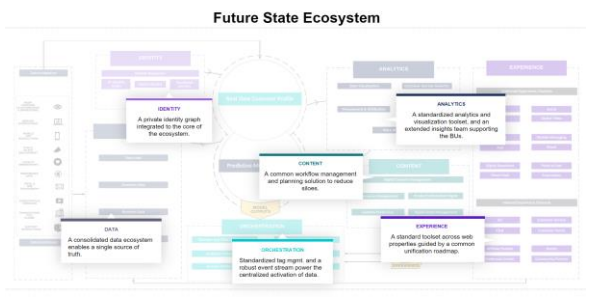
Current-state Architecture



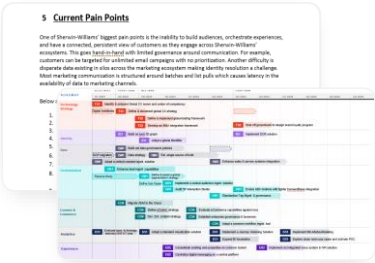
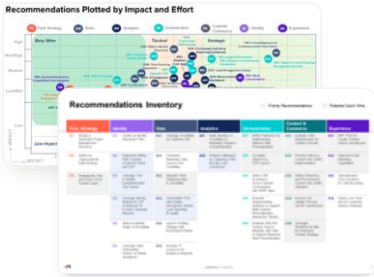
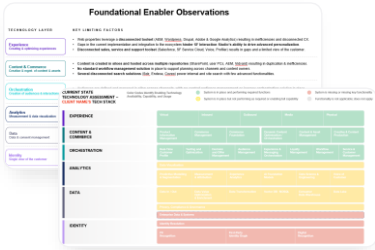
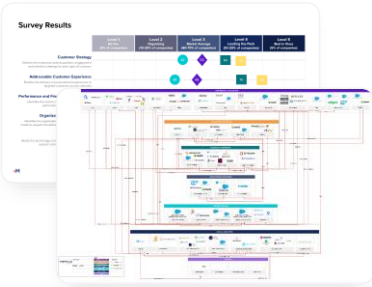
Future-state Technology Roadmap



Future-state Technology Vision



Typical Consulting Project Phases



01 Discovery

Inventory and understand current-state technology capabilities, operating environment, and future business vision.

02 Assessment

Gap analysis to benchmark current capabilities relative to best practices.

03 Recommendations

Define key recommendations to address the identified gaps with benefits, estimated effort, and resource options.

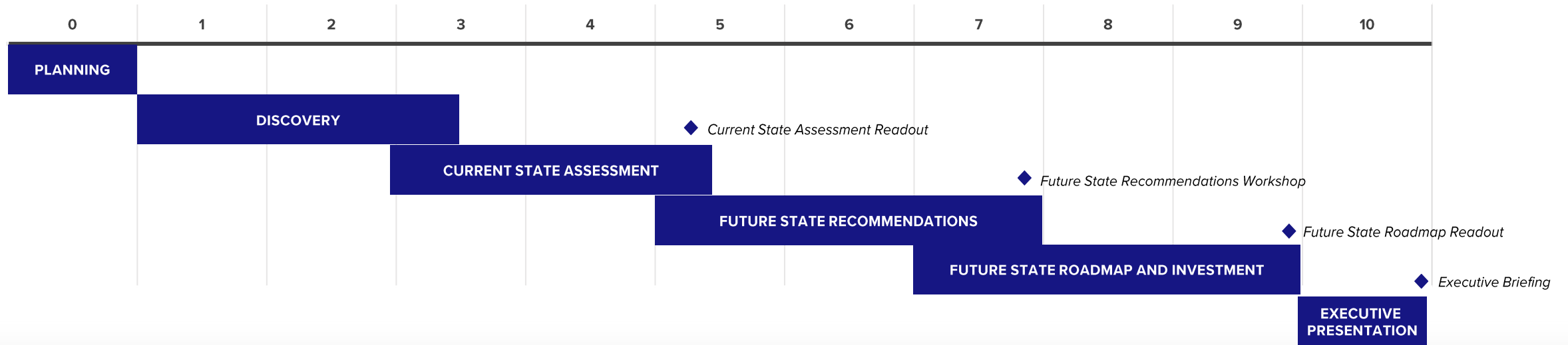
04 Roadmap

Craft a plan of sequenced initiatives over time, designed to deliver on the future-state vision.

05 Executive Summary

Develop and present an executive summary of the technology assessment engagement, including recommendation roadmap and investment case.

Typical 10-week Engagement Timeline



PLANNING

1 Week

- Stakeholder Prep
- Scheduling and Logistics

DISCOVERY

2 Weeks

- Stakeholder Interviews and Workshops
- Document Collection and Discussion
- Functional Roadmap Requirements

CURRENT STATE ASSESSMENT

2 Weeks

- Current State Evaluation and Implications
- Current State Ecosystem Documentation
- Maturity Assessment

FUTURE STATE RECOMMENDATIONS

3 Weeks

- Tech Stack Recommendations
- Future State Technology Blueprint

FUTURE STATE ROADMAP AND INVESTMENT

3 Weeks

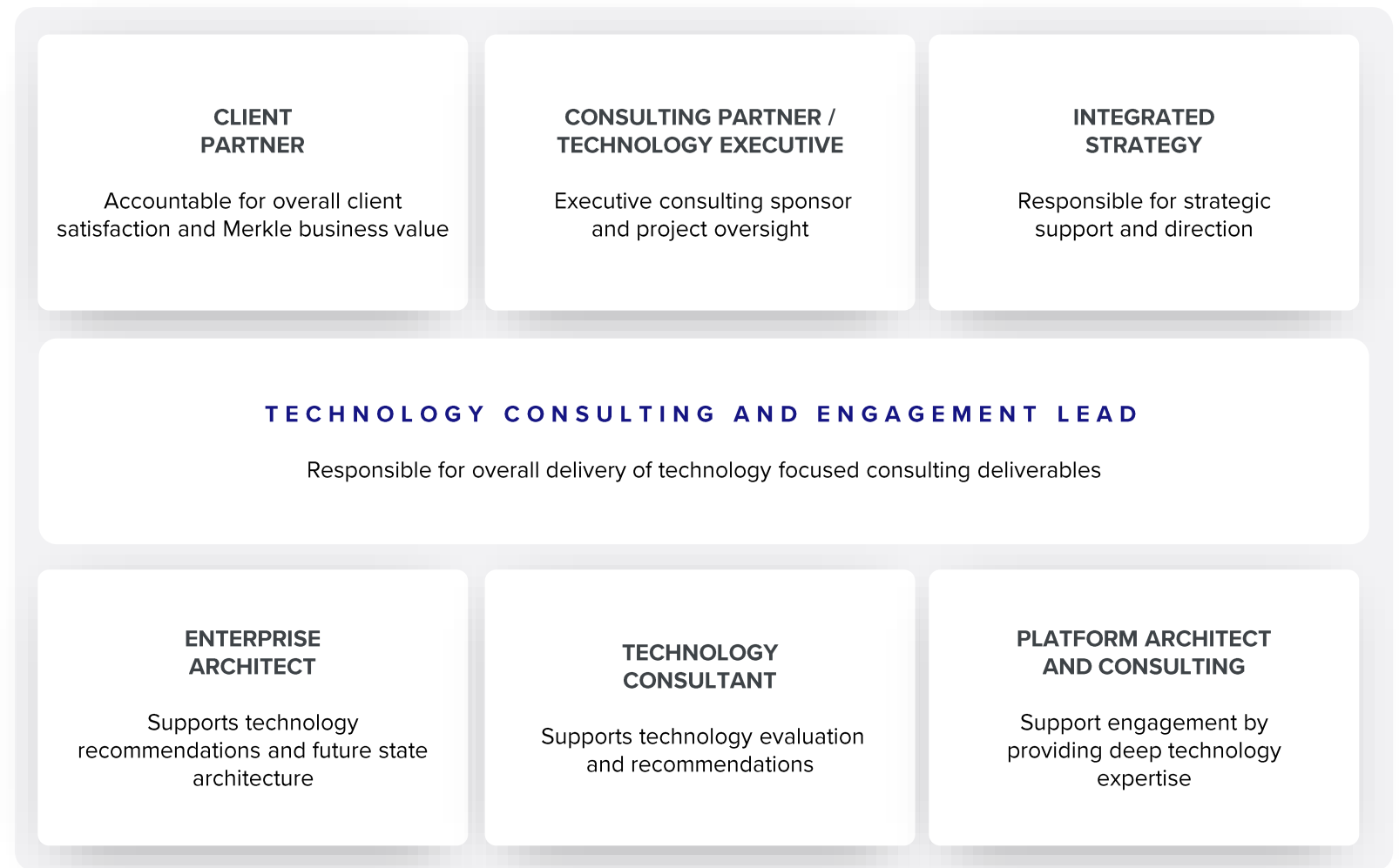
- Sequenced Multi-year Roadmap
- Technology Investment and Operating Estimates

EXECUTIVE PRESENTATION

1 Week

- Executive Reviews and Final Roadmap Presentation
- Solution Discussions

Typical Technology Consulting Engagement Model



Martech Roadmap Consulting Engagement Project Pricing

Pricing

\$200-240K

Includes conducting workshops, readouts, internal meetings, and status reporting

Timeline

10-12 Weeks

Timelines are estimated and target date is TBD

Resources

4+

Executive Sponsor, Principal, 2 Analyst, and SMEs for deep dives

Channels and Systems

Up to 10

Included as part of stakeholder interviews and discussions

Interviews

Up to 20

Across technology capabilities and including all follow-up discussions

- All on site work sessions time and location will be scheduled ahead of time
- SME's will be pulled in as necessary based on need (not included)
- Pricing doesn't include Travel and expense costs, est. to be 15% of total cost
- Any additional items or tasks may need to be assessed, scoped and may require additional costs

Why Merkle Technology Consulting?



BRIDGES

Merkle Technology Consulting **bridges the CIO/CMO gap** by developing an actionable sequence of recommendations that are tied to specific marketing goals and outcomes

30

EXPERIENCE

Marketing technology is the core of what Merkle has done for more than **30 years**



EXPERTISE

Merkle has depth across the breadth of marketing technology with more than **1000 technology professionals**, including subject matter experts in every component of the marketing technology stack



FRAMEWORKS

Merkle leverages multiple frameworks that support **efficiency, speed, and value**



IMPLEMENTATION

Merkle has hands on **technology implementation experience**, which brings a real-world approach to developing strategic technology recommendations



AGNOSTIC

Merkle Technology Consulting is not beholden to any **single technology agnostic approach**

MARTECH ROADMAP

CURRENT STATE TECHNOLOGY ASSESSMENT

Discern and articulate how the current state technology capabilities and ecosystem align with the business vision and best practices.

Approach

- Understand future state marketing requirements and goals.
- Collect and review existing documentation and artifacts.
- Business and technical discovery interviews and walkthroughs.
- Identify key themes including assets (what's working), gaps (what's not working) and opportunities for improvement between current state and required future capabilities.

Value

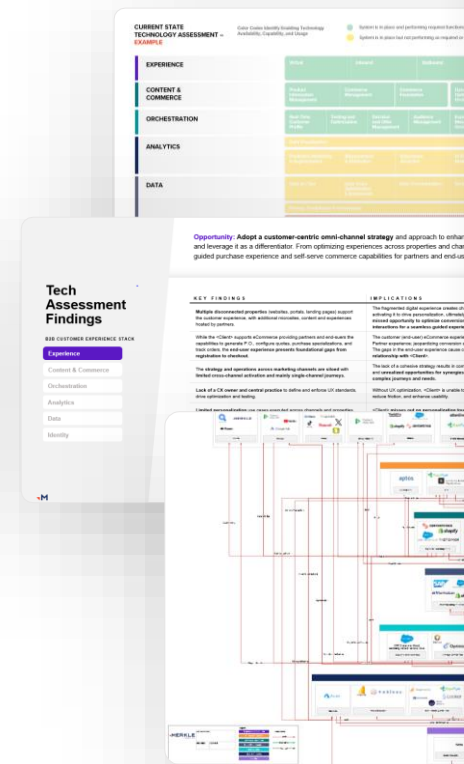
- Holistic view into how customer data is captured, integrated and leveraged throughout the organization.
- Provides visibility into how systems are or are not integrated, what information silos are present and what automated or manual processes exist.
- Merkle's POV into gaps which are impending customer-centric CRM, introducing risk, and creating inefficiencies.
- Identification of current systems and processes that are currently working well and should be maintained/enhanced.
- Serves as the basis to formulate program and technology recommendations.

DELIVERABLES

- Detailed current state data ecosystem mapping of information flows across systems.
- Current state assessment and gap analysis across all technology components and capabilities.
- Survey results with industry benchmarks.

MAY INCLUDE

- Visual capability assessment
- Key findings and implications
- Documented current state ecosystem



MARTECH ROADMAP

FUTURE STATE TECHNOLOGY RECOMMENDATIONS AND BLUEPRINT

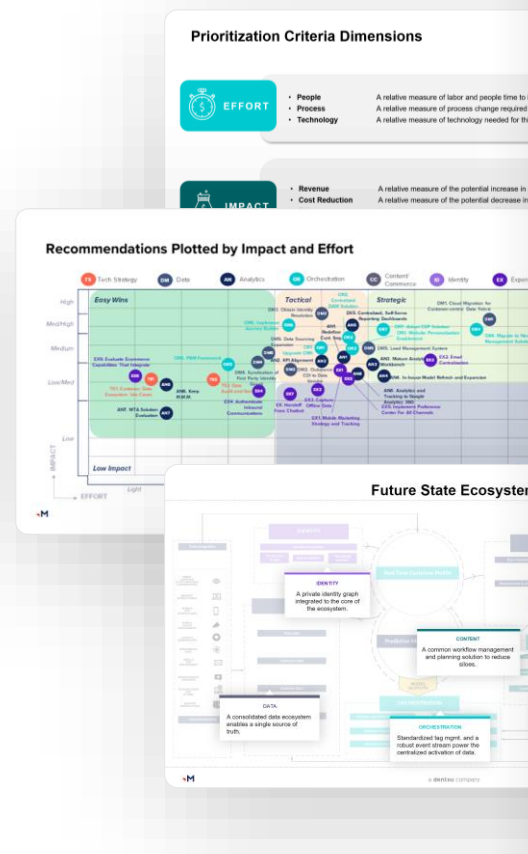
Create specific, actionable technology initiatives to close identified gaps to achieve the desired future state.

Approach

- Identify essential capabilities and functionality required to fill gaps and enable identified requirements based on learnings from assessment, applicable best practices and business goals
- Depict recommended content ecosystem components and how they could integrate
- Recommend initiatives required to active or enhance each of the ecosystem components along with their effort and impact

Value

- Actionable recommendations to evolve technologies and fill identified gaps to meet future state vision
- Clear view into the future technology ecosystem and best practices as it relates to business strategy – including key components, information flows



DELIVERABLES

- Future state technology recommendations and quick wins
- Future state conceptual technology blueprint
- Mapping of recommendations based on effort and business impact

MAY INCLUDE

- Recommendation value alignment
- Recommendation prioritization
- Future state technology blueprint

MARTECH ROADMAP

FUTURE STATE TECHNOLOGY ROADMAP

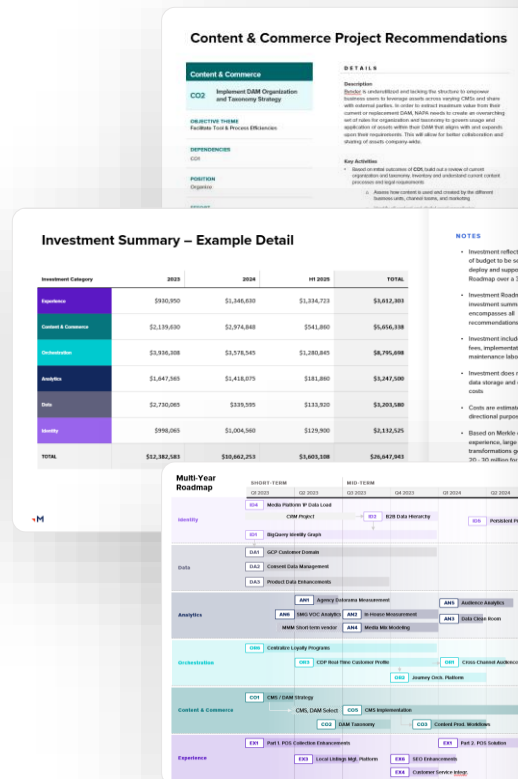
Actualize a high-level plan of sequenced initiatives and activities, designed to achieve the future state vision.

Approach

- Outline appropriate progression of recommendations into a high-level plan based on business impact, logical sequencing, business pacing and complexity
- Define a logical phasing spanning multiple years; typically, 3-5 years for strategic view and 1-2 years for deployment view
- Detail the investment requirements and month-to-month running costs per phase
- Link roadmap phases and outcomes to business use cases showing direct financial impact of activities if required

Value

- Clear and actionable plan with identified dependencies and timelines
- Investment estimations useful for budget planning and projections to execute on the roadmap



DELIVERABLES

- Multi-phase Future State Enablement Roadmap
- Investment Summary

MAY INCLUDE

- Detailed project cards
- Roadmap project cost estimations
- Detailed multi-phased roadmap

MARTECH ROADMAP

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Develop and present an executive summary of the technology assessment engagement, including recommendation roadmap and investment case.

Executive summary-level presentation to key stakeholders and Executive Summary leave-behind documentation (PowerPoint presentation with Appendix detail).

Approach

- Summarize deliverables from all stages of the engagement
- Include key engagement learnings, recommendations, future state vision, and investment aspects geared towards an executive-level audience
- Receive feedback, revise, and present results

Value

- Concise synopsis of all completed work products, key findings and critical actions
- Enables streamlined communication and socialization across the organization for easier buy in and path to execution



DELIVERABLES

- Customized final deliverable document based on synthesis of the work done in the prior phases.
- Unique for each client based on their needs to sell the roadmap to the organization.

MAY INCLUDE

- Building the roadmap for the future
- Outcomes drive to detailed recommendations
- Key projects and roadmap: CX stack outcomes

Merkury Consumer 360

ENGAGEMENT



OFFERING DETAILS

Merkury Consumer 360

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Consumer data is often siloed throughout an organization and not easily accessible or actionable to the people and teams who would create value from it.

OBJECTIVE

The Merkury Consumer 360 solution can leverage any of the major cloud platforms along with Snowflake preferred data warehousing to create the foundation for analytic activities, insight creation, efficient availability of consumer profile data for activation across online and offline platforms. All in support of maturing our clients' CX.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

Ongoing Managed Services, SF Data Cloud/Adobe AEP/ActionIQ implementation/integration, Analytics, Merkury expansion (Merkury Tag, Media), Channel Execution (Adobe, SF, Braze), Enterprise Data Consultation

CLIENTS

Cracker Barrell, Amica, AARP, Sherwin-Williams, SoFi, Abercrombie & Fitch, Feld

APPROACH & DELIVERABLES

- Discovery and requirements definition/documentation
- Solution architecture and data flow definition/documentation
- Infrastructure instantiation
- Solution development and testing
- User acceptance testing
- Solution availability

MERKLE PRODUCTS & IP

- Merkury Enterprise
- Snowflake Native Apps
 - Merkle – Data Loader
 - Merkle – Data Profiler
 - Merkle – Identity Connector
 - Merkle – Audience Publisher



Investment: see engagement models

Timing: 4-9 months

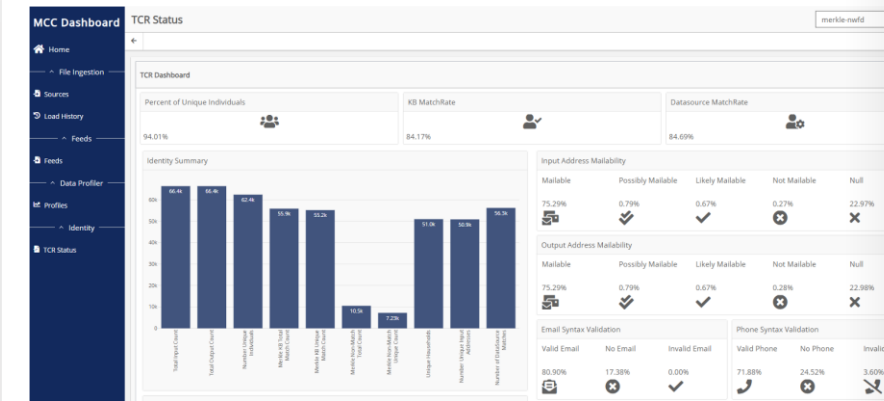
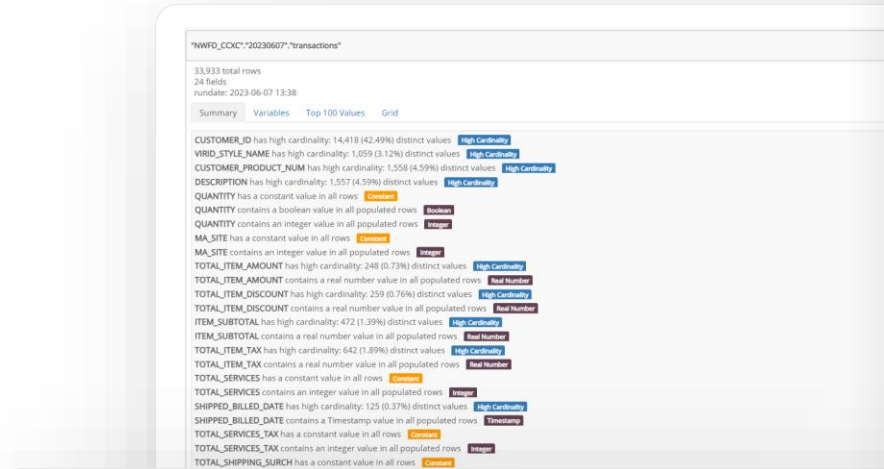
Outcomes:

- Increased ability to derive value from technology platforms
- Long term internal capability development (option)

Implementation Engagement Models

	SMALL	MEDIUM	LARGE	X-LARGE
Timeframe	2+ months	4+ months	6+ months	10+ months
Team Locale	US and India	US and India	US and India	US and India
Planned Releases	1	2	2 – 3	4
Consumption Marts	0	Campaign Mart Reporting Mart	Campaign Mart Reporting Mart Secondary Database	Campaign Mart Reporting Mart Secondary Database
Business Rules & Aggregates	0	1 – 25	26 – 50	21 – 75
Ownership Model	Merkle-Owned and Managed	Merkle-Owned and Managed	Merkle-Owned and Managed	Merkle-Owned and Managed
Build Fee	\$ 120,000+	\$ 525,000+	\$ 1,200,000+	\$ 2,900,000+

Merkury Consumer 360



Description and Activities

Stand up Environment

Provision either Merkle or Client Public Cloud environment and deploy Connected Code modules as Snowflake Native Apps. Provision Client access to environment with applicable Role-Based Security (RBS)

Ingest Data

Drop data files into Cloud storage and automatically ingest and profile data

Cleanse and Dedupe Data

Process data through our Terrestrial Identity engine (Merkury) to cleanse and match against a reference base of ~270M records. Assign IDs at the individual, address and household level.

Identity Dashboards

Profile your customer universe using BI tools to understand key data points about your customers (Match to reference base, Geo, Emailability, etc.)

Solution Automation and Monitoring

Managed Services team to monitor automated data processing and proactively escalate any issues that arise.

Merkury Consumer 360

Description and Activities

Kick-Off and planning administration	Kickoff project, Identify SMEs, Map out timelines
Set up Infrastructure (cloud env, tools, integration points)	Request for cloud infrastructure, tools, etc.
Document inbound and outbound data sources (Data Dictionary)	Review and document list of data sources (Feed Name, layout, Expected Volumes, Frequency)
Data Ingestion and Profiling	Client/inbound vendors share inbound data feeds
Business and Functional Requirements	Define solution from a business and functional perspective
Identity Processing Validation	Review outputs of Identity Processing to ensure and custom rules defined are met
Data Model Diagram	ERD is developed for Merkle consumption
Source to Target mapping	Data Lineage that defines how sources flow through all components of the solution
Integration points established / tested (if applicable)	Establish and test connections to downstream systems (CDPs, Campaign tools, et.)
Test Plan / Test Case Execution	Client-specific test plan and detailed test cases to be validated before Client UAT
Client UAT	Delivery of solution to client team to validate and approve functionality
Fully Tested Solution	Promotion of the tested and approved solution to Production
Transition and Managed Services Support	Hypercare monitoring and ultimate transition to Managed Services for monitoring and enhancements

Implementation Success

Mature delivery practice that allows the team to focus in the right areas, at the right time.

PLAN AND DISCOVER

- Kick-off and team alignment
- Use case definition
- Success metrics
- Definition and prioritization of business requirements
- Testing strategy and plan
- Infrastructure and access
- Project definition and release planning

DESIGN AND DEVELOP

- Solution architecture
- Integration points
- Entity relationship diagram
- End-to-end data flows
- Functional Requirements
- End user tools definition
- Data delivery
- Identity resolution
- Data lake (conformed layer)
- Consumption layer
- Integration development
- Functional testing

TEST AND ITERATE

- End-to-end testing
- Use case validation
- Dev and test cycles
- Client UAT
- Solution acceptance

MIGRATE AND STABILIZE

- Solution and team readiness
- On-boarding of Managed Services team
- Knowledge transfer to all stakeholders
- Production cut over
- Hypercare period

FOUNDATION

Iterative Releases

BUILD

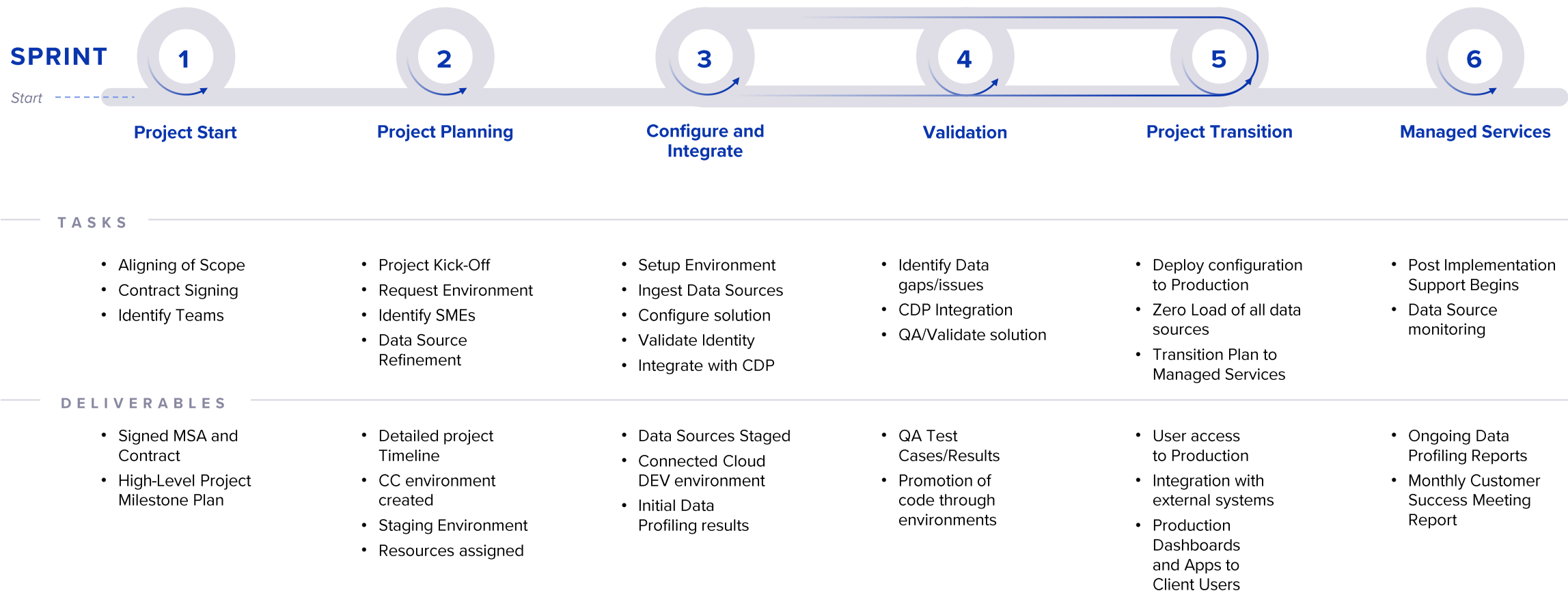
Iterative Releases

READINESS

Iterative Releases

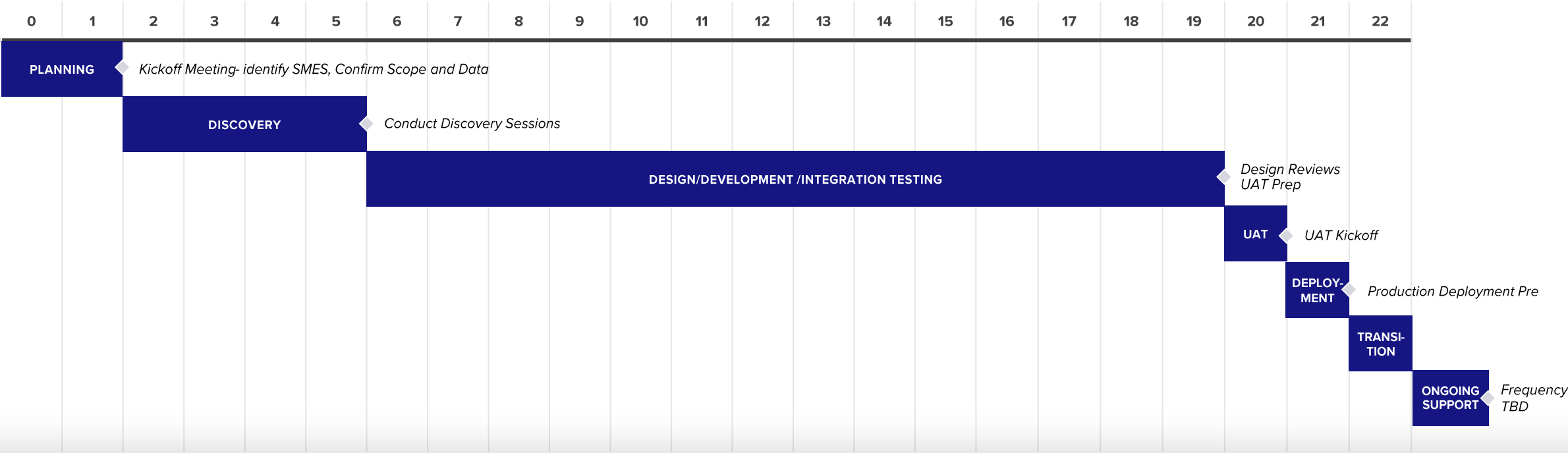
LAUNCH

Agile-Based Implementation Sprint Plan



Sprints may be broken into Sub-Sprints based on scope defined

Sample Waterfall Project Timeline



PLANNING	DISCOVERY	DESIGN/DEVELOPMENT /INTEGRATION TESTING	UAT	DEPLOYMENT	TRANSITION	ONGOING SUPPORT
2 Weeks	4 Weeks	14 Weeks	1 Week	1 Week	1 Week	Post-Transition
• Project Plan • List of SMES	• Document Requirements • Data Profile/Analysis Results	• UAT Plan and Test Cases	• Client acceptance of solution • UAT Punch List	• Solution deployed to Production		

Merkle Products

Merkle's products, including GenCX and Mercury, offer industry-leading capabilities. Many offerings leverage these products to deliver strengthened client outcomes including the Mercury Consumer 360 solution. Having Merkle-owned platforms in use client-side also strengthens our relationships with key clients.

Product	How it's Used	Key Outcomes	Commercial Considerations
Mercury Data	Mercury Data can be easily integrated into any unified consumer data solution to enhance a client's first party data.	- Enhance first party data profiles - Extend prospecting universe - Enhance personalization efforts	Additional contracting necessary for both data append and use of Mercury data for prospecting
Mercury Identity	Mercury Identity is a key component of our unified consumer data solution, providing a consumer level identifier.	- Consumer level identifier provided to connect 1st party data - ID to connect to digital ecosystem including all Mercury Enterprise assets (Data, Tag, Mercury for Media for digital audience publishing)	Additional contracting necessary for both use of other Mercury enterprise options (Data, Tag, Media)
Mercury Tag	Identify visitors to brands' websites and connect that web site engagement to all other consumer engagement to create complete customer profiles and trigger enhanced retargeting communications	- Increased web site identification - Increased retargeting reach and performance	Additional contracting necessary for both use of other Mercury Tag
GenCX	Democratize data within the Mercury Consumer 360 solution and lessen time to market for valuable data insights via chat based interface	- Democratize data across the organization - Drive data driven insights - Amplify value from existing analytics team	Additional contracting necessary for GenCX (infrastructure and services) based on use cases

Market Commercial Enablement

The content developed in this section will be used for internal training and education purposes. This is needed to provide sellers with the necessary context and information to successfully sell the offering.

OFFERING

Merkury Consumer 360



Buyers & Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

WHO SHOULD WE SPEAK TO?

Title	Sample topics / pain points to address
CEO	• How can I better strengthen and leverage our most valuable asset – our customer data – to drive innovation, competitive advantage, and maximum value to the organization?
CMO/CXO	• How do I deliver more personalized experiences consistently across channels? • How do I inform our customer experience with data from traditionally non-marketing channels (like call centers, customer service, and point of sale)?
CTO/CIO	• How do we collaborate with our marketing organization to realize more capabilities, performance, and returns from our CX tech investments? • How can I help improve CX when customer data is in legacy systems/not in the cloud?
CDO/VP, Data	• How do I connect data from across the enterprise to enable a holistic view of our customers to drive personalization and support other business initiatives? • How do I ensure this is done securely and in compliance?
VP Analytics	• How do I leverage our customer data – in real time and across disparate channels – to predict the next best interaction (offer, content, pricing, channel, etc) with our customers? • How can I connect data to measure our CX and help make it more effective/efficient? • How can I leverage AI/ML Models to better inform measurement and segmentation?
VP, Commerce	• How do I leverage customer data and insights to create more shoppable moments? • How can I bring our B2B buying experience more in line with the kind of B2C experiences our customers expect?
VP Digital, Activation, Messaging	• How should I be target and measure activation in a post cookie world? • How can I automate customer data to build segments and optimize my media spend?
Alliance AE	• Reach out to the Alliances team at Merkle to identify who the AE is at the Cloud Provider (AWS, GCP, Snowflake) to see if there is an open opportunity for which we can deliver services. Find out who the Alliance AE is talking to at the client – it is often a different line of business than where we have relationships and can expand your network at the client. Alliances may have budget funding to help pay for the opportunity.

OFFERING

Merkury Consumer 360



Buyers & Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

IDEAL CLIENT PROFILE

Ideal · client · profile (ICP)

Identifying an ICP bolsters a company’s sales strategy by hyper-targeting only those prospects or potential clients who are most likely to benefit from your company’s offerings. For Merkury Connected Cloud, the ICP looks like

For Enterprise Sales Leaders

- All Verticals – Tier 1, 2 and 3
- This offering is a necessary part of any composable CDP solution
- Look for clients with legacy or dated tech platforms
 - Acxiom Clients
 - Epsilon People Cloud Clients
 - Clients with distributed or martech stack with multiple point solutions

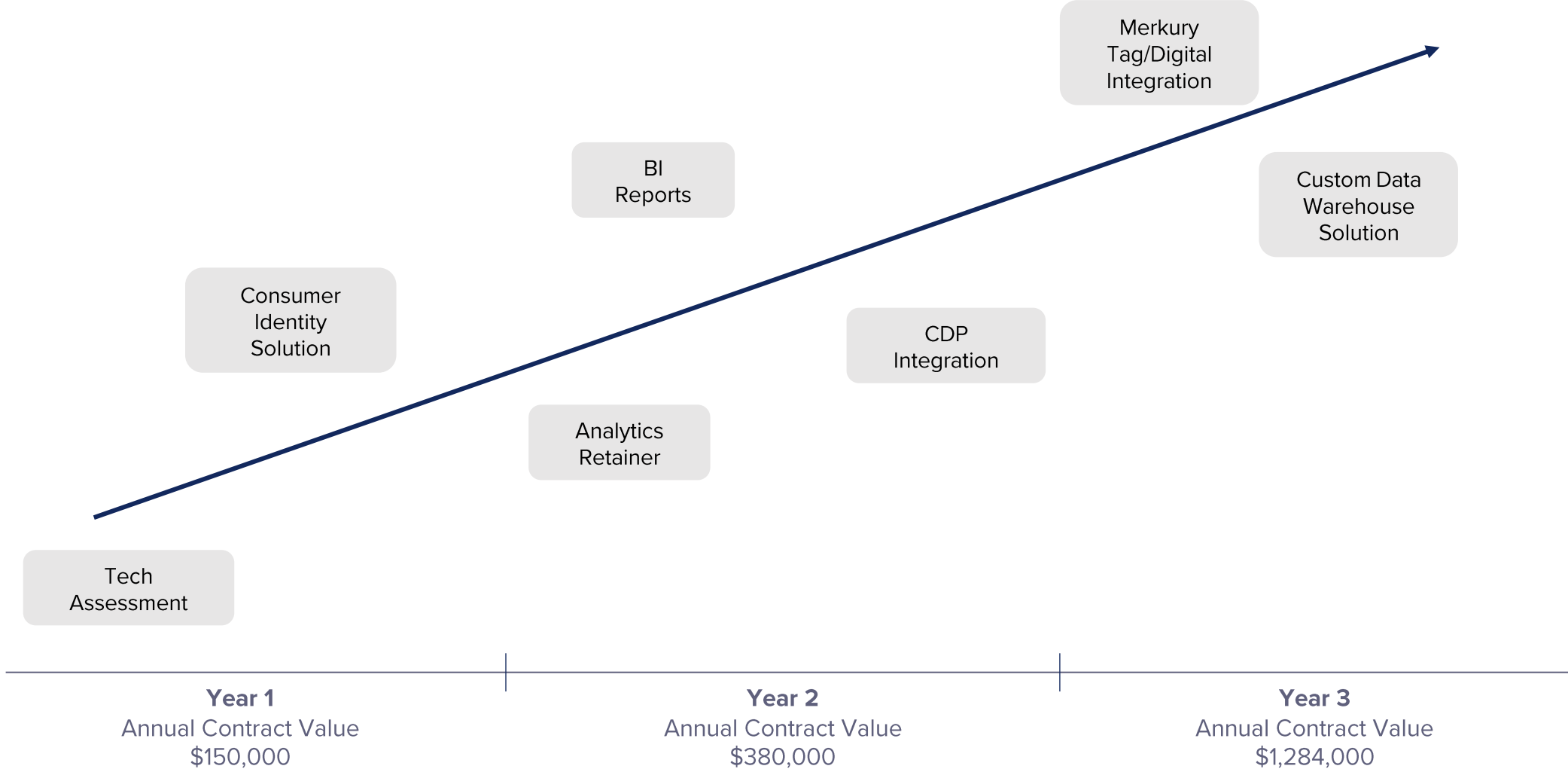
For Client Partners

- This offering is a necessary part of any composable CDP solution
- Clients with on-prem solutions
- Clients where marketing has difficulty accessing data for various use cases
- New client relationship in IT
- Clients with distributed or martech stack with multiple point solutions
- Clients who leverage Qualtrics

For Inside Sales Leaders

- This offering is a necessary part of any composable CDP solution
- Look for clients with legacy or dated tech platforms
 - Acxiom Clients
 - Epsilon People Cloud Clients
 - Clients with distributed or martech stack with multiple point solutions

How a Merkury Consumer 360 engagement can grow



Buyers & Industries.

Guidance on buyer opportunities and problems, as well as outcomes the offering drives.

Target Industries.

Describe specific industries or verticals where this offering is particularly relevant.

INDUSTRY	WHY IT MATTERS	WHAT TO LISTEN FOR	DO WE HAVE VERTICAL-SPECIFIC CONTENT?	KPIS
Financial Services	Managing data risk, agend of the bureau, and modernization is crucial for compliance and competitive edge.	Client concerns about regulatory compliance, interest in data security solutions, and queries about cloud-based financial systems.	Yes, please request case studies or other industry specifics from offering owner	Increase in customer identification rates, omni-channel campaign efficiencies and revenue lift from personalization and CRM.
Healthcare	Data privacy and patient experience are paramount, driving the need for secure, modern solutions which allow connection across brands and inidcations.	Client discussions on HIPAA compliance, patient data security, and digital transformation in patient care.	Yes, please request case studies or other industry specifics from offering owner	• 62% lift in monthly average conversions over 6 months • 18% lift in overall engagement • 23% click-to-open rate for sample retention audiences • Centralized Segmentation leading to maturity in Omni Channel Intelligent Retargeting • Expanded to automated Abandon Browse and price drop programs
Retail	Advanced customer experiences and data modernization can significantly boost sales and customer loyalty through customer centric data driven approaches.	Client interest in personalized marketing strategies, data-driven customer insights, and omnichannel retail solutions.	Yes, please request case studies or other industry specifics from offering owner	Improved data and identities, launch omnichannel journeys, drove process efficiencies which resulted in demonstrated 16% lift in CTR and revenue impact
High Tech	Staying ahead with advanced customer experiences is key to innovation and market leadership.	Client curiosity about integrating AI and ML for predictive analytics, and questions on data interoperability.	Yes, please request case studies or other industry specifics from offering owner	25% average boost in ROI from personalized programmatic bidding and content algorithms.
Media and Entertainment	Maximizing ROI on media spend is essential in a highly competitive market.	Client focus on audience engagement metrics, content monetization strategies, and real-time analytics for media planning.	Yes, please request case studies or other industry specifics from offering owner	• Better Engagement rate than In-Market Facebook audiences/Google Search Network • +20% Higher conversion rate • 118% increase in signups
Travel and Leisure	Enhancing customer experience and loyalty is key in a highly service-oriented industry.	Client discussions on improving booking systems, personalizing travel experiences, and loyalty program effectiveness.	Yes, please request case studies or other industry specifics from offering owner	



OFFERING

Merkury Consumer 360

Commercial Guidance

Guidance on price point, market size, and competitive landscape for an offering in a given market.



Who's this for? CMO, Marketing Directors, Media Directors:

Unique Features:

- Epsilon PeopleCloud CDP**: Known for AI-powered email marketing and strong integration with first-party data.
- Axiom Customer Intelligence Cloud**: Emphasizes ethically sourced data and privacy compliance.
- Salesforce CDP**: Renowned for its CRM platform and extensive training resources.
- Merkury Enterprise by Merkle**: Focuses on person-based identity growth and real-time site identity recognition.

Feature	Epsilon PeopleCloud CDP	Axiom Customer Intelligence Cloud	Salesforce CDP	Merkury Enterprise by Merkle
Product Feature Descriptions	AI-powered email marketing, unifies first-party data, modular, scalable, CORE ID integration	Identity resolution, integrated marketing cloud, data, identity, analytics solutions, privacy compliance	CRM platform, unified customer profiles, privacy management, data ingestion	Person-based identity growth, hyper-personalized experiences, connectivity to internal systems
Data Integration	High, first-party data focus, integrates third-party data	High, CORE ID for data unification, connects to BigQuery	High, various integrations, Salesforce CRM	High, connectivity to internal systems, integrates with third-party platforms
User Interface	User-friendly, AI-driven insights	User-friendly, centralized control, loyalty marketing focus	Intuitive, training and support materials	User-friendly, real-time site identity, real-time personalization and retargeting
Customer Insights	Real-time campaign performance, deep customer behavior insights	Comprehensive consumer profiles, personalized conversations	Insights from global survey, actionable insights from unified data	Insights and audience segmentation, enhances customer and prospect IDs
Personalization	Personalized consumer journeys at scale	Personalized experiences driven by real-time behavior	Personalized experiences through various clouds, marketing activation	Real-time identity and data-enabled site personalization, hyper-personalized brand experiences
Privacy and Security	Ethically sourced data, privacy-compliance, privacy-safe clean room	GDPR and CCPA compliance, navigates changing privacy landscape	Secure cloud infrastructure, privacy management, data security	Privacy-safe data assets, identity resolution, long-term value and portability of ID solutions
Data Enrichment Capabilities	Data-heavy solution, enhances data with proprietary data	Data enhancement, award-winning solutions, Identity Assurance services	Data enrichment through ecosystem, customer segments, event-focused data sources	Consumer data enhancement, augments brand data with audience and shopper insights
Identity Resolution Management	Interoperable with Unified ID 2.0, CORE ID for better reach and scale	Real Identity and Identity Assurance services, recognizes customers across channels	Identity resolution through ecosystem, advanced resolutions, data linking	Person-based master ID and graph creation, unifies known and unknown customer records
Customer Experience Management	End-to-end view of marketing performance, connected customer experiences	Personalized experiences across channels, relevant cross-channel intelligence	Comprehensive management, transforms experiences with unified data	Real-time retargeted CRM and service based on behaviors, identity-based clean rooms
Technical Implementation Difficulty	Moderate, scalable and modular offerings, deliberate roadmap	Moderate, detailed consumer profiles, easy integration of data	Varies, extensive training resources, moderate to high	Moderate, real-time connectivity, high match-rates to Merkury person ID
Data Engineering Effort	Significant, focus on measurement and attribution solutions	Significant, first-party data solutions, data health and analytics	Varies, extensive platform offerings, data ingestion and management	Significant, identity growth and data connectivity, single source of truth
Approximate Implementation Timeline	Varies, typically 3-6 months	Varies, typically 3-6 months	Varies, typically 6-12 months	Varies, typically 3-6 months
Cost	Competitive, custom pricing based on needs and scale, media investment focus, high	Competitive, addressability solutions focus, include yearly license, usage-based, one-off purchase, and monthly license, high	Competitive, custom pricing, per-license, various cloud solutions, high	\$50k-\$1.5M+ USD, high
Market Size	Global reach, key industries focus, large	Global reach, every marketable U.S. household, large	Global reach, wide range of cloud solutions, large	Global reach, over 120 clients leveraging Merkury, large
Key Alliances	Strategic partnerships, data interoperability, Unified ID 2.0	Partnerships with key data providers and platforms, over 130 integrations	Extensive partner ecosystem, connections to other Salesforce portfolio solutions	Partnerships within Merkle and dentsu network, alliances with tech innovators
CDP Partners	Epsilon PeopleCloud CDP and typically does not partner with other CDP providers	Over 130 integrations with key data providers and platforms like Adobe, Salesforce, Sitecore, and Treasure Data to deliver these services	Extensive partner ecosystem within Salesforce portfolio	Partnerships within Merkle and dentsu network, alliances with tech innovators
Cloud Service Providers	Integration with major cloud services, AWS, Google Cloud	Integration with major cloud services, Google Cloud	Salesforce's own cloud infrastructure, Salesforce, AWS	Runs on Dentsu Connect, leveraging a suite of technologies and applications

OFFERING

Merkury Consumer 360



Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

CASE STUDIES

Include at least three case studies related to your offering. If you have cases already built out, feel free to include in this deck.

Client	Project	Market	Description	Outcomes
Sofi	Building a Loan Acquisition Engine	Financial Services	Differentiated and customized offers for new lending products. Omni-channel engine leveraging direct mail and email. Partnership with Merkle for consumer lending and audience management expertise.	Introduction of mortgages, personal loans, and credit cards. Overcame competition in student lending. Differentiation of product offers across audiences.
Citizens Bank	Launching a National Online Bank	Financial Services	Launched a national online bank for deposit fueling loan growth. Brand recognition and competitive direct bank environment challenges. Targeted digitally savvy customers seeking convenience.	\$1 billion in deposits within three months of launch. \$3 billion deposit goal in the first six months. Created a unique savings experience.
Cracker Barrel	Developing a Unified Loyalty Design	Retail	Enabled guest recognition across channels using first-party data. Loyalty program for dine-in, to-go, catering, and retail. Built on heritage for a differentiated loyalty program.	Accelerated guest experience with unified loyalty design. Personalized rewards leveraging Martech stack. Significant business and guest impact.
UPR	Operating Model Transformation	Media and Entertainment	Broke down functional silos for integrated marketing planning and execution. Defined and operationalized a Collaborative Workflow Operating Model. Standardized processes and clarified roles across marketing and sales.	Aligned marketing and sales activities across UPR. Drove clear accountability and optimized ways of working. Enhanced learning process with audience insights and channel performance.

Partner Smarter

Merkle partners with leading global brands to create differentiation and disruption through a proven framework of data and experience transformation.

Experience

Marketing data, analytics, and technology are the core of what Merkle has done for more than 40 years.

Acceleration

Merkle consistently delivers faster time to value through proven outcome and industry accelerators, one-click deployment solutions, self-service capability options, and an open architecture approach.

Alliances

Merkle partners with the leading Martech and Cloud providers to bring customers a best-of-breed technology set to meet their specific use cases.

Bridges

Our technology strategy and consulting group bridges the CIO/CMO gap by developing actionable recommendations tied to specific marketing goals and outcomes. And our managed services team continues to bridge that gap in the long term with a data driven, customer experience lens on consumer data management.

Expertise

Merkle has depth across the full spectrum of Martech, with more than 1,000 technology professionals, including subject matter experts in every component of the CX stack.

Use Case Approach

With extensive hands-on technology implementation and operations experience, Merkle brings a real-world approach to professional and advisory services that accelerate critical business outcomes.

A Recognized Leader

Merkle ranked as a Leader in The Forrester Wave™: Customer Data Strategy and Activation Services, Q2 2022 report by leading independent research firm Forrester Research, Inc. Areas of excellence where we received the highest scores possible include:



- First-party PII management
- Marketing technology
- Cross-channel marketing execution
- Execution Roadmap

OFFERING

Merkury Consumer 360



Sales Guidance

Help selling through the offering, from handling objections to understanding similar/competitive offerings where they exist.

TREND 1 NARRATIVE

The Empowering of AI with First-Party Data

Current marketing and customer experience trends center on Personalization, AI-driven insights, and the strategic use of first-party data. With digital signals and identifiers, including Third-party cookies, businesses rely more on first-party data collected from direct customer interactions. This shift allows for more personalized and privacy-compliant marketing, enabling brands to tailor experiences across digital channels.

AI plays a pivotal role in transforming first-party data into actionable insights. Marketers can now deliver real-time, hyper-personalized experiences at scale through the power of machine learning and predictive analytics. AI's ability to identify patterns and customer behaviors is driving better segmentation and targeting, opening up a world of possibilities for personalized marketing.

While Customer Data Platforms (CDPs) are essential for activating this data and storing the unified customer profiles, they are not a silver bullet. More than a CDP is needed to address the complexities of managing and processing data from multiple sources. This is where data engineering becomes vital—ensuring data is appropriately collected, cleaned, and integrated into workflows. Without solid data pipelines, even advanced AI models and CDPs can produce flawed insights, undermining marketing efforts.

Data engineering is the backbone that enables seamless integration across marketing tools, ensuring that high-quality, accurate data fuels AI and personalization strategies. This emphasis on data engineering should reassure businesses that their data is reliable and can be trusted to drive their marketing success.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- First-Party Data Strategy: "As reliance on third-party data fades, how are you adapting your strategy to collect and leverage first-party data from your customers?"
- AI and Personalization: "How are you using AI and machine learning to create personalized experiences for your customers, and what challenges are you facing?"
- Customer Data Platform (CDP) Use: "Are you currently using a Customer Data Platform (CDP), and if so, are you finding it effective in integrating all your customer data sources?"
- Data Engineering and Integration: "How confident are you in the accuracy and quality of your data, and what steps have you taken to ensure that your data pipelines are robust?"
- Privacy and Compliance: "With increasing privacy regulations, how are you ensuring compliance while delivering personalized experiences that drive customer engagement?"

OFFERING

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TREND 2 NARRATIVE

Move to Composable Customer Data Platforms (CDPs)

Composable Customer Data Platforms (CDPs) are rapidly gaining traction as a flexible alternative to traditional, monolithic CDPs. Unlike pre-packaged CDPs, composable CDPs allow businesses to build a modular data infrastructure, integrating best-of-breed components for data collection, processing, and activation. This approach provides greater customization and scalability, enabling organizations to adapt to their specific needs and evolving martech landscapes.

In 2025, businesses should expect further advancement in composable CDPs, focusing more on real-time data processing, AI-driven insights, and seamless platform integration. The flexibility of a composable stack allows marketers to adopt emerging technologies without overhauling their entire system. However, this also increases complexity, requiring strong data engineering and governance practices to ensure data quality, consistency, and privacy compliance.

As brands prepare for 2025, they should focus on several key areas:

1. Data Integration: With the rise of composable CDPs, ensuring smooth and efficient data integration across different components will be essential.
2. Real-time Capabilities: Customers increasingly expect real-time Personalization, so businesses must be able to activate data instantly across channels.
3. AI and Automation: Leveraging AI to process and activate data will become critical for optimizing customer experiences at scale. AI can be used to analyze large volumes of data, identify patterns, and predict customer behavior, enabling businesses to deliver personalized experiences in real-time. This level of automation is essential for keeping up with customer expectations and market trends.
4. Privacy and Compliance: As regulations evolve, composable CDPs must include built-in compliance mechanisms to securely manage consent and data privacy.

Ultimately, a composable approach offers more agility, but businesses must invest in data engineering and AI to fully realize its potential by 2025.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Composable CDP Strategy: "Have you explored moving to a composable CDP model, where you can integrate best-of-breed solutions instead of relying on a single, monolithic platform?"
- Data Integration Challenges: "What challenges are you facing with integrating data across your various platforms, and how are you managing data consistency and quality?"
- Real-Time Data and Personalization: "How important is real-time data activation in your customer experience strategy, and are your current systems capable of supporting that?"
- AI and Automation in Data Activation: "Are you leveraging AI and automation to optimize how you activate customer data, and if not, where do you see the biggest opportunity for improvement?"
- Privacy and Compliance Management: "With increasing privacy regulations, how confident are you that your current CDP setup can handle evolving compliance needs without slowing down your marketing efforts?"



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Sales Guidance

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TREND 3 NARRATIVE

Clean rooms maximize media spend insights while ensuring privacy

Clean rooms will be a critical tool for brands and agencies looking to gain deeper insights into the effectiveness of their media spend. Clean rooms are secure, privacy-compliant environments where first-party data from brands can be combined with aggregated data from media platforms (such as Google, Facebook, or retail media networks) without directly sharing sensitive information. As third-party cookies disappear and data privacy regulations grow more stringent, clean rooms provide a solution that allows marketers to measure their media campaigns' true impact while respecting user privacy.

One key advantage of clean rooms is the ability to perform multi-platform attribution. Since clean rooms allow data from different sources to match without revealing individual identities, brands can better understand how their media investments across different platforms contribute to conversions and sales. This offers a clearer picture of which media channels and campaigns are driving the most value.

Additionally, clean rooms enable deeper audience insights. By securely combining customer data with anonymized platform data, marketers can refine targeting strategies, optimize messaging, and personalize media campaigns in ways that were not possible before.

To fully leverage clean rooms, brands must ensure they have a robust data strategy in place, with clean, well-governed first-party data ready for integration. In 2025, clean rooms will be indispensable for any brand serious about maximizing media spend ROI while navigating an increasingly privacy-conscious environment. Brands that invest in this technology will optimize their marketing performance and drive business growth.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Media Attribution: "How confident are you in understanding which media channels drive the most conversions for your campaigns?"
- Cross-Platform Measurement: "Do you struggle with tracking media effectiveness across multiple platforms while maintaining customer privacy?"
- Data Privacy and Compliance: "How are you handling data privacy and compliance in your current media measurement and analytics practices?"
- First-Party Data Utilization: "Are you fully leveraging your first-party data to optimize media targeting and performance across various advertising platforms?"
- Multi-Platform Insights: "Would you benefit from a secure, privacy-compliant way to combine data from platforms like Google, Facebook, and retail media networks to gain deeper insights into media effectiveness?"



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Outcomes obsession.

OUTCOME	DESCRIPTION	WHY IT'S CRITICAL
Real-time Consumer Profile	Provides a comprehensive view of the consumer, enabling personalized experiences.	Enhances customer engagement and loyalty through tailored interactions.
Audience Activation	Enables precise targeting and segmentation for marketing campaigns.	Increases campaign effectiveness and ROI by reaching the right audience.
Activation Integrations	Integrates with various platforms for seamless activation across channels.	Provides flexibility and efficiency in campaign management.
Data Governance and Quality	Ensures data integrity and compliance with regulations.	Builds trust with customers and avoids legal penalties.
Identity Resolution	Creates a single unified ID for each customer across digital and terrestrial touchpoints.	Improves cross-channel marketing efforts and customer understanding.
Advanced Analytics	Delivers insights and models for better decision-making.	Drives business intelligence and performance reporting for strategic growth.
25% Average Boost in ROI	Achieved through personalized programmatic bidding and content algorithms.	Directly impacts the bottom line by maximizing media spend efficiency.

About Merkle's 2024 GTM

OUR VISION IS TO BE THE BUSINESS THAT IS

PURPOSE-BUILT TO POWER EXPERIENCE TRANSFORMATION

We put people at the heart of what we do

We believe experience-led business transformation results in uncommon growth, profitability, and long-term customer value

We are the only integrated experience consultancy ready for an AI-first future

We balance creativity and practicality by integrating design, strategy, technology, and data all as first-class citizens – the ability for a single firm to handle strategy, design, and implementation is a **top two** selection criteria (Forrester)

We deliver multi-dimensional industry, domain, and technology platform expertise

Technology and industry expertise are **top two** and **three** selection criteria for a partner respectively (Forrester); industry expertise and deep alliance partnerships are force multipliers for our business

We are obsessed with outcomes

From maximizing the return on value of technology investments to delivering data-driven strategies for measurable business improvement, our performance heritage fuels our focus

OUR PROMISE

We power the experience economy.

OUR PROPOSITIONS



Growth & Business Agility



Future-Ready Technology



Customer-First Experiences



Brand Loyalty & Engagement

Offerings

OUR CAPABILITIES

EXPERIENCE & PRODUCT DESIGN

ENGAGEMENT & LOYALTY

PLATFORMS & ENGINEERING

ANALYTICS & INSIGHTS

CONSULTING & BUSINESS OPERATIONS

Services

OUR PRODUCTS

 MERKURY

 GENCX

OUR PROMISE

We **power** the experience economy.

OUR PROPOSITIONS



Growth & Business Agility



Future-Ready Technology



Customer-First Experiences



Brand Loyalty & Engagement

Offerings

OUR CAPABILITIES

EXPERIENCE & PRODUCT DESIGN

ENGAGEMENT & LOYALTY

PLATFORMS & ENGINEERING

ANALYTICS & INSIGHTS

CONSULTING & BUSINESS OPERATIONS

Services

OUR PRODUCTS

 MERKURY

 GENCX

GTM BUSINESS ARCHITECTURE

EXTERNAL

INTERNAL

OUR PROMISE

Our differentiated perspective on the market and right to play

- Why we do what we do (theory of the firm) and an expression of our market vision
- The role we play in unlocking the broader dentsu integrated value proposition

OUR PROPOSITIONS & OFFERINGS

The territories brands must address to win in the experience economy; value propositions are gateways for us to have insightful, consultative conversations with the market focused on business value drivers

Offerings

What we repeatably and reliably do as a business to address challenges and seize on the opportunities identified in value propositions

- A common foundation for our marketing, verticals, and alliances
- A mechanism to: increase the portability of our best work and thinking across regions and teams; integrate interdisciplinary capabilities, services, and teams in service of client outcomes
- An integration layer for Merkle to cross-dentsu and practice solutions

OUR CAPABILITIES & PRODUCTS

Capabilities: Five common capabilities that answer the question: “what exactly do we do?” Validated as contemporary and future-looking capabilities against competitors, with analysts, and a small group of trusted, senior client buyers across functions (CTOs, CMOs, CDOs, CXOs)

Services: A more granular services breakdown related to our five capabilities

Validated as contemporary and future-looking capabilities against competitors, with analysts, and a small group of trusted, senior client buyers across functions (CTOs, CMOs, CDOs, CXOs) and markets.

Products: Market-leading technologies that not only amplify our work, but available directly to clients.

